



# Develop interpretive content for eco-tourism activities

D2.TTO.CL4.07

Trainee Manual





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**Trainee Manual**



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# Introduction to trainee manual

## To the Trainee

Congratulations on joining this course. This Trainee Manual is one part of a 'toolbox' which is a resource provided to trainees, trainers and assessors to help you become competent in various areas of your work.

The 'toolbox' consists of three elements:

- A Trainee Manual for you to read and study at home or in class
- A Trainer Guide with Power Point slides to help your Trainer explain the content of the training material and provide class activities to help with practice
- An Assessment Manual which provides your Assessor with oral and written questions and other assessment tasks to establish whether or not you have achieved competency.

The first thing you may notice is that this training program and the information you find in the Trainee Manual seems different to the textbooks you have used previously. This is because the method of instruction and examination is different. The method used is called Competency based training (CBT) and Competency based assessment (CBA). CBT and CBA is the training and assessment system chosen by ASEAN (Association of South-East Asian Nations) to train people to work in the tourism and hospitality industry throughout all the ASEAN member states.

What is the CBT and CBA system and why has it been adopted by ASEAN?

CBT is a way of training that concentrates on what a worker can do or is required to do at work. The aim of the training is to enable trainees to perform tasks and duties at a standard expected by employers. CBT seeks to develop the skills, knowledge and attitudes (or recognise the ones the trainee already possesses) to achieve the required competency standard. ASEAN has adopted the CBT or CBA training system as it is able to produce the type of worker that industry is looking for and this therefore increases trainees chances of obtaining employment.

CBA involves collecting evidence and making a judgement of the extent to which a worker can perform his or her duties at the required competency standard. Where a trainee can already demonstrate a degree of competency, either due to prior training or work experience, a process of 'Recognition of Prior Learning' (RPL) is available to trainees to recognise this. Please speak to your trainer about RPL if you think this applies to you.

What is a competency standard?

Competency standards are descriptions of the skills and knowledge required to perform a task or activity at the level of a required standard.

242 competency standards for the tourism and hospitality industries throughout the ASEAN region have been developed to cover all the knowledge, skills and attitudes required to work in the following occupational areas:

- Housekeeping
- Food Production
- Food and Beverage Service
- Front Office



- Travel Agencies
- Tour Operations.

All of these competency standards are available for you to look at. In fact you will find a summary of each one at the beginning of each Trainee Manual under the heading 'Unit Descriptor'. The unit descriptor describes the content of the unit you will be studying in the Trainee Manual and provides a table of contents which are divided up into 'Elements' and 'Performance Criteria'. An element is a description of one aspect of what has to be achieved in the workplace. The 'Performance Criteria' below each element details the level of performance that needs to be demonstrated to be declared competent.

There are other components of the competency standard:

- *Unit Title*: statement about what is to be done in the workplace
- *Unit Number*: unique number identifying the particular competency
- *Nominal hours*: number of classroom or practical hours usually needed to complete the competency. We call them 'nominal' hours because they can vary e.g. sometimes it will take an individual less time to complete a unit of competency because he or she has prior knowledge or work experience in that area.

The final heading you will see before you start reading the Trainee Manual is the 'Assessment Matrix'. Competency based assessment requires trainees to be assessed in at least 2 – 3 different ways, one of which must be practical. This section outlines three ways assessment can be carried out and includes work projects, written questions and oral questions. The matrix is designed to show you which performance criteria will be assessed and how they will be assessed. Your trainer and or assessor may also use other assessment methods including 'Observation Checklist' and 'Third Party Statement'. An observation checklist is a way of recording how you perform at work and a third party statement is a statement by a supervisor or employer about the degree of competence they believe you have achieved. This can be based on observing your workplace performance, inspecting your work or gaining feedback from fellow workers.

Your trainer and or assessor may use other methods to assess you such as:

- Journals
- Oral presentations
- Role plays
- Log books
- Group projects
- Practical demonstrations.

Remember your trainer is there to help you succeed and become competent. Please feel free to ask him or her for more explanation of what you have just read and of what is expected from you and best wishes for your future studies and future career in tourism and hospitality.



# Unit descriptor

## Develop interpretive content for eco-tourism activities

This unit deals with the skills and knowledge required to Develop interpretive content for eco-tourism activities in a range of settings within the travel industries workplace context.

### Unit Code:

D2.TTO.CL4.07

### Nominal Hours:

70

## Element 1: Research information

### Performance Criteria

- 1.1 Describe the interpretive approach to guiding and activities
- 1.2 Identify sources of information for eco-tourism knowledge
- 1.3 Determine customer interests and potential themes for possible interpretive activities
- 1.4 Use research techniques to obtain information
- 1.5 Classify and store information
- 1.6 Verify information that has been gathered
- 1.7 Learn the required information to support identified eco-tourism concepts, themes and focal points

## Element 2: Prepare an eco-tourism activity

### Performance Criteria

- 2.1 Develop and determine concepts, themes and focal points for potential eco-tourism activities
- 2.2 Acquire physical resources to support identified eco-tourism concepts, themes and focal points
- 2.3 Generate scripted commentaries to support identified eco-tourism concepts, themes and focal points
- 2.4 Trial developed eco-tourism activities for identified concepts, themes and focal points
- 2.5 Revise developed eco-tourism activities on the basis of feedback
- 2.6 Promote prepared eco-tourism activities

## **Element 3: Update knowledge and eco-tourism activities**

### **Performance Criteria**

- 3.1 Take action to receive information from relevant bodies
- 3.2 File and share new information
- 3.3 Incorporate new knowledge in existing activities
- 3.4 Create new activities
- 3.5 Correct information and activities that prove to be inaccurate or misleading

# Assessment matrix

## Showing mapping of Performance Criteria against Work Projects, Written Questions and Oral Questions

The Assessment Matrix indicates three of the most common assessment activities your Assessor may use to assess your understanding of the content of this manual and your performance - Work Projects, Written Questions and Oral Questions. It also indicates where you can find the subject content related to these assessment activities in the Trainee Manual (i.e. under which element or performance criteria). As explained in the Introduction, however, the assessors are free to choose which assessment activities are most suitable to best capture evidence of competency as they deem appropriate for individual students.

|                                                   |                                                                                                    | Work Projects | Written Questions | Oral Questions |
|---------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------|-------------------|----------------|
| <b>Element 1: Research information</b>            |                                                                                                    |               |                   |                |
| 1.1                                               | Describe the interpretive approach to guiding and activities                                       | 1.1           | 1,2               | 1              |
| 1.2                                               | Identify sources of information for eco-tourism knowledge                                          | 1.2           | 3,4               | 2              |
| 1.3                                               | Determine customer interests and potential themes for possible interpretive activities             | 1.3           | 5,6               | 3              |
| 1.4                                               | Use research techniques to obtain information                                                      | 1.4           | 7,8               | 4              |
| 1.5                                               | Classify and store information                                                                     | 1.5           | 9,10              | 5              |
| 1.6                                               | Verify information that has been gathered                                                          | 1.6           | 11,12             | 6              |
| 1.7                                               | Learn the required information to support identified eco-tourism concepts, themes and focal points | 1.7           | 13,14             | 7              |
| <b>Element 2: Prepare an eco-tourism activity</b> |                                                                                                    |               |                   |                |
| 2.1                                               | Develop and determine concepts, themes and focal points for potential eco-tourism activities       | 2.1           | 15,16             | 8              |
| 2.2                                               | Acquire physical resources to support identified eco-tourism concepts, themes and focal points     | 2.2           | 17,18             | 9              |
| 2.3                                               | Generate scripted commentaries to support identified eco-tourism concepts, themes and focal points | 2.3           | 19,20             | 10             |
| 2.4                                               | Trial developed eco-tourism activities for identified concepts, themes and focal points            | 2.4           | 21,22             | 11             |

|                                                               |                                                                              | Work Projects | Written Questions | Oral Questions |
|---------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------|-------------------|----------------|
| 2.5                                                           | Revise developed eco-tourism activities on the basis of feedback             | 2.5           | 23                | 12             |
| 2.6                                                           | Promote prepared eco-tourism activities                                      | 2.6           | 24                | 13             |
| <b>Element 3: Update knowledge and eco-tourism activities</b> |                                                                              |               |                   |                |
| 3.1                                                           | Take action to receive information from relevant bodies                      | 3.1           | 25                | 14             |
| 3.2                                                           | File and share new information                                               | 3.2           | 26                | 15             |
| 3.3                                                           | Incorporate new knowledge in existing activities                             | 3.3           | 27                | 16             |
| 3.4                                                           | Create new activities                                                        | 3.4           | 28,29             | 17             |
| 3.5                                                           | Correct information and activities that prove to be inaccurate or misleading | 3.5           | 30                | 18             |

# Glossary

| Term                        | Explanation                                                                                                                                                                          |
|-----------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Blog</b>                 | A discussion or informational site                                                                                                                                                   |
| <b>Commentaries</b>         | Information provided by the tour guide to tour group members as part of a tour                                                                                                       |
| <b>Community</b>            | A social unit of any size that shares common values                                                                                                                                  |
| <b>Conservation</b>         | Is the act of preserving, guarding, or protecting                                                                                                                                    |
| <b>Duty of Care</b>         | A legal obligation which is imposed on an individual requiring adherence to a standard of reasonable care while performing any acts that could foreseeably harm others               |
| <b>Eco-system</b>           | An ecosystem is a community of living organisms in conjunction with the nonliving components of their environment (things like air, water and mineral soil), interacting as a system |
| <b>Eco-tourism</b>          | Form of tourism involving visiting and understanding fragile, exotic, pristine, relatively undisturbed or threatened natural areas                                                   |
| <b>EMP</b>                  | Emergency Management Plan                                                                                                                                                            |
| <b>Fauna</b>                | All the animal life of any particular region or time                                                                                                                                 |
| <b>Flora</b>                | Flora is the plant life occurring in a particular region or time, generally the naturally occurring or indigenous—native plant life                                                  |
| <b>Guiding</b>              | One who shows the way by leading, directing, or advising                                                                                                                             |
| <b>Interpret</b>            | Explain the meaning of                                                                                                                                                               |
| <b>Interpretive guiding</b> | Use of interpretive activities and presentation techniques by a tour guide when conducting a tour                                                                                    |
| <b>KPI</b>                  | Key Performance Indicator                                                                                                                                                            |
| <b>Media</b>                | The collective communication outlets or tools that are used to store and deliver information or data                                                                                 |

| Term                            | Explanation                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |
|---------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Message</b>                  | Stand-alone but important statement which makes sense on its own but nonetheless underpins and supports the theme for an activity                                                                                                                       |
| <b>PA System</b>                | Public Address System                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
| <b>PFD</b>                      | Personal flotation device                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |
| <b>POETRY</b>                   | P = Purposeful<br>O = Organised<br>E = Enjoyable or Engaging, or Entertaining<br>T = Thematic<br>R = Relevant to the audience<br>Y = You (the tour guide)                                                                                               |
| <b>PPE</b>                      | Personal protective equipment                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
| <b>Primary data</b>             | Data collected for a specific purpose                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
| <b>Primary themes</b>           | Define the most essential ideas                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
| <b>Qualitative information</b>  | Gathers information that is not in numerical form. For example, diary accounts, open-ended questionnaires, unstructured interviews and unstructured observations.<br><br>It is descriptive data and as such is harder to analyse than quantitative data |
| <b>Quantitative information</b> | Type of information or data that is based on quantities obtained using a quantifiable measurement process. In contrast, qualitative information records qualities that are descriptive, subjective or difficult to measure                              |
| <b>Script</b>                   | A prepared commentary of information that is to be presented to customers                                                                                                                                                                               |
| <b>Secondary data</b>           | Generic information that already exists                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
| <b>Secondary themes</b>         | Provide valuable, but non-essential information related to the unifying and primary themes                                                                                                                                                              |
| <b>Sensory</b>                  | Pre-determined information presenting in a logical order for communication with customers                                                                                                                                                               |
| <b>Supporting themes</b>        | Provide more detailed perspectives on one or more of the primary themes                                                                                                                                                                                 |
| <b>Theme</b>                    | 'The take home message' for the visitors                                                                                                                                                                                                                |

| Term                  | Explanation                                                                      |
|-----------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Unifying theme</b> | Provides a conceptual focus and general approach for the interpretive offerings  |
| <b>VISIT</b>          | Voluntary Initiative for Sustainability in Tourism"                              |
| <b>Volunteering</b>   | An activity where an individual or group provides services for no financial gain |





# Element 1: Research information

## 1.1 Describe the interpretive approach to guiding and activities

### Introduction

Like in any tour, the need for interpretive guiding is essential to ensure that not only is a tour conducted in a professional manner, full of interesting facts and activities, but ultimately an enjoyable experience for the customer.

This is essential for any tour, especially for eco-tourism related activities.

Understanding the term eco-tourism and the approach for an interpretive activity must be the starting point for identifying the basis for an interpretive activity.

This section defines the nature of eco-tourism and discusses interpretive guiding and its application.



### Definition of eco-tourism

When we think of tourism, most people picture a resort on a beautiful beach or walking through a beautiful forest. In many cases tourism is directly related to nature. Therefore it is no coincidence that the more a tourism attraction is visited, the greater the impact on the environment.



Tourism relies heavily on the environment. Natural resources (beaches, seas, mountains, lakes, rivers) and manmade resources (historic cities, heritage buildings and sites, monuments) constitute the primary source of tourism. Any degradation of the primary sources is likely to lead to a decline of tourism.

The role of tourism has always been to promote tourists to visit attractions, many of which are natural. It is also important that any impact of conducting tourism activities in an area, leave the smallest environmental footprint.

As the environment changes and concern about these changes grows, there is an increasing need to be aware of the impact that businesses have on the environment.

The quality of the environment, whether it be man-made or natural, is essential to tourism.

That said, tourism's relationship with the environment is complex indeed. It involves many various tourism related activities that can have adverse effects on the environment.

Many of these impacts are linked with the construction of infrastructure to support tourism operations such as the general need for roads and airports, and of tourism facilities, including resorts, hotels, restaurants, shops, golf courses and marinas.

The negative impacts of tourism development can gradually destroy the environmental resources on which it depends. This is a prime concern that must be addressed.

On the other hand, tourism has the potential to create beneficial effects on the environment by contributing to environmental protection and conservation. It is a way to raise awareness of environmental values and it can serve as a tool to finance protection of natural areas and increase their economic importance.

In essence, ecotourism is a form of tourism involving visiting and understanding fragile, exotic, pristine, relatively undisturbed or threatened natural areas.

In order to preserve the environment eco-tourism is aimed as a low-impact small scale alternative to standard commercial mass tourism.

Whilst the list of purposes of eco-tourism is endless, common purposes of eco-tourism include:

- Educate travellers
- To provide funds for ecological conservation
- To directly benefit the economic development and political empowerment of local communities
- To generate respect for different cultures and for human rights.



As the amount of limited natural resources depletes, the importance of eco-tourism will become more important for future generations.

Generally, ecotourism deals with living aspects of the natural environments.

Ecotourism focuses on socially responsible travel, personal growth, and environmental sustainability. Ecotourism typically involves travel to destinations where flora, fauna, and cultural heritage are the primary attractions.

Ecotourism is intended to offer tourists insight into the impact of human beings on the environment, and to foster a greater appreciation of our natural habitats.

## Interpretive guiding



Interpretive guiding can be seen as the use of interpretive activities and presentation techniques by a tour guide when conducting a tour.

Their use makes a tour a much more memorable experience for participants.

Interpretive guiding goes beyond the basic provision of information which is seen by many as their sole objective when conducting a tour.

Interpretive guiding refers to interpretation of the topics (see below) which are the focus of the tour or encountered along the way.

In many ways interpretive guiding seeks to make people care about, and care for, topics and subjects which are the focus of interpretive activities.

## Interpretive techniques

Interpretive techniques are ways of communicating information to visitors.

Interpretive guiding commonly uses face-to-face methods and is frequently supported by interpretive media and aids.

It can utilise a wide range of options which will be expanded on and discussed in more detail in Section 2.1. As an introduction they include:

- Role playing
- Using different voice techniques
- Story-telling
- Playing of games
- Conducting activities
- Presenting demonstrations
- Delivering participant interaction situations
- Holding sensory awareness exercises
- Using materials to enhance illustration and experiences
- Utilising technology to assist with delivery
- Identifying further links where interested participants can find more information if they want to – when the tour has concluded.



## Commentaries

It is important to note at the start of this manual that one of the main elements of 'interpretive content' is through the development and use of commentaries.

A 'commentary' refers to information provided by the tour guide to tour group members as part of a tour.

It has two distinct elements:

- Scripted commentary – which:
  - Is consistent information provided to every customer on every tour
  - Includes regular interpretive activities – provided as part of every tour
- Non-scripted information – that is researched and developed to enable tour guides to respond to questions asked by tour group members.

The scripted commentary should be thought of as a guide about what needs to be said on tour rather than a complete list of everything that will be said.

In this context the commentary **does not** refer to:

- Handout materials provided to customers before or during the tour – which contain information and advice relevant to the tour and its destinations or inclusions



- DVDs – which may be screened as part of pre-tour briefings, on the coach, at destinations or before activities
- Information provided by ‘other people’ who contribute to the delivery of the tour experience – such as people at destinations and attractions or other independent or ‘external’ tour guides who may be engaged for sections of the tour.

The process and considerations of developing commentaries will be discussed in more detail in Section 2.3 of this manual.

## Factors which might provide the context

There is always a context for interpretive activities provided as part of a tour.

There may be ‘just one’ factor providing the context but commonly a blend or combination of factors will determine the context.

Relevant factors include:

### ***The subject that is the basis of the activity***

These can be identified:

- By the tour operator – for the advertised type or nature of tour, or the name given to the tour
- By the tour group – in terms of their special requests.

### ***Integration into other considerations***

This can include:

- A wider focus for the overall tour
- Other. diverse interpretive activities and tour experiences being conducted on tour
- The need to factor destination-specific needs such as:
  - Product development – of individual tours
  - Site development initiatives
  - General and local community needs, wants and preferences – as opposed to what tour groups want.

### ***Background to the activity***

This can relate to issues such as:

- Geographic or physical locations where activities may need to occur
- Cultural and heritage considerations which might impact the activity
- Religious festivals.



### ***Resources available***

To develop and present the activity in terms of:

- Time needed for the activity
- Human resources and staff capability to conduct the activity – in terms of certification, accreditation, skills, experience and expertise
- Physical resources – needed to conduct the activity which might relate to sports equipment, safety gear, artefacts and other necessary items
- Financial resources – the budget available to support development and implementation.

### ***Thoughts and opinions***

In relation to the activity that is the focus of the eventual presentation in terms of:

- Presenting the thoughts and opinions from certain eras
- Tracing or tracking the evolution of current thoughts and opinions
- Contrasting current thoughts and opinions with thoughts and opinions from previous times
- Relating thoughts and opinions to other aspects of the tour – such as food, buildings, language. Political events societal developments.



### ***Need to comply with mandatory obligations***

These can be imposed by:

- Internal policies and procedures as specific to the individual tour operator
- Legislated obligations imposed by the country in which the interpretive activity takes place
- Agreements negotiated by the host community in which the tour is being conducted
- Operational Codes which exist in various location in terms of Codes of Ethics, Codes of Practice and Codes of Conduct.



### ***Feedback that has been received from past tour group members***

This can relate to topics such as:

- What they enjoyed, wanted to continue or wanted more of
- What they wanted but which was not addressed or covered as part of the tour
- What they did not enjoy, wanted to discontinue or wanted less of.

### ***The need to apply relevant guiding principles***

This may relate to:

- General guiding principles
- The thematic interpretive formula for interpretive guiding.



## Key features of interpretive guiding

Interpretive approach commonly uses face-to-face methods and is frequently supported by interpretive media and aids.

The interpretive approach includes activities aiming to:

### ***Provide a verbal commentary***

This is often a blend of scripted and unscripted, aimed to:

- Set the scene
- Deliver basic information
- Explain and translate the characteristics, significance and features of the tour and or the individual activity.



### ***Facilitate understanding***

This is achieved through a combination of actions such as:

- Defining words, terms, phrases, abbreviations and acronyms
- Inspiring tour group members
- Making whatever is on the tour or whatever the tour is about meaningful to those who are part of the tour.

### ***Give local and cultural context***

By attributing meaning to:

- Sites
- Sights
- Activities
- Events.



### ***Conduct appropriate and meaningful activities***

This is aimed to:

- Encourage and enable learning
- Enhance understanding
- Develop awareness.

### ***Contextualise the tour and activities***

This can be done within:

- A local framework
- Local flavour
- Other experiences of the tour group.

### ***Generate respect and appreciation***

For:

- The local customs
- Local history and heritage
- Local people and communities.



### ***Provoke and encourage intellectual activity***

Such as:

- Curiosity
- Thought
- Personal reflection.

### ***Bring the tour to life***

By:

- Providing opportunities for learning
- Including activities where people can actively participate
- Supplying hands-on activities.



### ***Build relationships***

Between:

- The tour group and the environment
- Participants and the community
- The tour party and whatever topics or subjects are the focus of the tour or activity.

### ***Provide explanations and give examples of information provided***

In order to:

- Create memorable experiences
- Assist tour groups to investigate
- Make relevant comparisons with previous times, other communities, different orientations.



## Need to understand interpretive activity plans

Understanding interpretive activity plans is the basis of implementing interpretive activity plans.

In practice there is a need for tour guides to obtain answers to seven very important questions:

1. Why is the interpretive activity being conducted?
2. When is the interpretive activity to be presented?
3. Where is the interpretive activity to be conducted?
4. Who is involved in the activity?
5. How is the interpretive activity to be conducted or presented?
6. What resources are available to deliver the interpretive activity?
7. Have necessary permissions to conduct the activity been obtained?



Note: more information on these topics is provided below and also in the unit previously identified 'Plan, develop and evaluate interpretive activities'.

## POETRY

One approach used for interpretive guiding is the acronym POETRY. This formula states delivery to tour groups must be:

- P = Purposeful
- O = Organised
- E = Enjoyable or Engaging, or Entertaining
- T = Thematic
- R = Relevant to the audience
- Y = You – highlighting that the Tour Guide needs to be themselves and inject their own personality and enthusiasm into what they do.



## Fifteen Principles of Interpretation

The following appears in 'Foundations of Interpretation: curriculum, content, narrative NPS – Interpretive Development Program: Professional standards for learning and Performance' (National Parks Service, US Department of the Interior) available at <http://www.nps.gov/idp/interp/101/FoundationsCurriculum.pdf> pp3-4):

*"Larry Beck and Ted Cable authored the book Interpretation for the 21st Century (1998) to provide direction in the field at the turn of the millennium. As professors who teach coursework in interpretation they have written extensively in the fields of natural resource management and interpretation. Building upon the work of Enos Mills and Freeman Tilden, they developed Fifteen Principles of Interpretation:*

1. To spark an interest, interpreters must relate the subject to the lives of visitors.
2. The purpose of interpretation goes beyond providing information to reveal deeper meaning and truth.
3. The interpretive presentation – as a work of art – should be designed as a story that informs, entertains, and enlightens.
4. The purpose of the interpretive story is to inspire and to provoke people to broaden their horizons.
5. Interpretation should present a complete theme or thesis and address the whole person.
6. Interpretation for children, teenagers, and seniors – when these comprise uniform groups – should follow fundamentally different approaches.
7. Every place has a history. Interpreters can bring the past alive to make the present more enjoyable and the future more meaningful.
8. High technology can reveal the world in exciting new ways. However, incorporating this technology into the interpretive program must be done with foresight and care.
9. Interpreters must concern themselves with the quantity and quality (selection and accuracy) of information presented. Focused, well-researched interpretation will be more powerful than a longer discourse.
10. Before applying the arts in interpretation, the interpreter must be familiar with basic communication techniques. Quality interpretation depends on the interpreter's knowledge and skills, which should be developed continually.
11. Interpretive writing should address what readers would like to know, with the authority of wisdom and the humility and care that comes with it.
12. The overall interpretive program must be capable of attracting support – financial, volunteer, political, and administrative – whatever support is needed for the program to flourish.
13. Interpretation should instil in people the ability, and the desire to sense the beauty in their surroundings – to provide spiritual up lift and to encourage resource preservation.
14. Interpreters can promote optimal experiences through intentional and thoughtful program and facility design.
15. Passion is the essential ingredient for powerful and effective interpretation – passion for the resource and for those people who come to be inspired by the same.”



Now that we have looked at the foundations of eco-tourism and the role of conducting 'interpretive activities', the rest of the manual will be aimed at discussing the ways to develop, prepare and conduct interpretive activities containing suitable content.



### ***Activity 1 – Importance of eco-tourism***

You are required to identify the importance of eco-tourism in your region.

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What are the benefits of eco-tourism to your region?

[illegible]



## Activity 2 – Identify eco-tourism activities

You are required to identify the eco-tourism tours or activities conducted in your region.

| ECO-TOURISM LOCATION | KEY FEATURES OF THE LOCATION | TYPES OF ECO-TOURISM ACTIVITIES |
|----------------------|------------------------------|---------------------------------|
|                      |                              |                                 |
|                      |                              |                                 |
|                      |                              |                                 |
|                      |                              |                                 |
|                      |                              |                                 |
|                      |                              |                                 |



## 1.2 Identify sources of information for eco-tourism knowledge

### Introduction

An essential aspects of conducting interpretive activities and providing accurate and informative content is to ensure that you are well versed in all aspects of:

- General eco-tourism issues and considerations
- Specific eco-tourism issues that apply to the region
- Eco-tourism facts and figures pertaining to the focal areas in which the tour will be based around.



In this section we will explore some of these points in further detail.

### Sources of information

There are many sources of information that can used to identify eco-tourism facts and figures including, but not limited to:

Relevant peak preservation and conservation bodies

There are peak ecotourism on a global and regional scale that can provide vital information relating to key eco-tourism attractions.



### ***Activity 3 – Visit The International Ecotourism Society website***

You are required to visit the website of **www.ecotourism.org** and answer the following questions:

What is the purpose of this website?

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What information can you find regarding eco-tourism in your region?

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How can this website help you as a tour guide conducting eco-tours?

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## **Ministries of Tourism**

Each country within the ASEAN region will have dedicated government ministry specifically focused on the tourism industry. Their role is to regulate and manage the industry.

A Ministry of Tourism, is normally responsible for the formulation of national policies and programmes and for the co-ordination of activities of various governments and the private Sector for the development and promotion of tourism in the country.

The Ministry may co-ordinate special initiatives including:

- Selecting and managing heritage sites
- Dedication and allocation of government funding to tourism initiatives
- Providing information on news laws and regulations
- Establishing service excellence awards
- Publishing and managing tenders for tourism projects

The ASEAN region, whilst working collectively to achieve a primary purpose of attracting tourism to the region as a whole, each participating government will also have their own websites and departments in which to collect information. They have been identified below.

### **BRUNEI**

Tourism Development Division  
Ministry of Industry and Primary Resources  
Jln. Menteri Besar, Bandar Seri Begawan, Brunei Darussalam  
Tel. (673-2) 382822 Fax. (673-2) 382824  
Email: [info@bruneitourism.travel](mailto:info@bruneitourism.travel)  
Website: <http://www.bruneitourism.travel>

### **CAMBODIA**

Ministry of Tourism  
3, Preah Monivong Blvd, Phnom Penh, Cambodia  
Tel. (855-23) 213911 Fax. (855-23) 426107 or 217503  
Email: [dgpro@camnet.com.kh](mailto:dgpro@camnet.com.kh)  
Website: <http://www.tourismcambodia.com>



### **INDONESIA**

Ministry of Culture and Tourism  
Jl. Medan Merdeka Barat 17, Jakarta 10110, Indonesia  
Tel. (62-21)3838157 Fax. (62-21) 3849715  
Website:  
<http://www.budpar.go.id>  
<http://www.my-indonesia.info>

### **LAOS**

National Tourism Authority of Lao P.D.R.  
Lane Xang Avenue, P.O. Box 3556, Vientiane, Lao P.D.R.  
Tel. (856-21) 212248 Fax. (856-21) 212769 or 2127910  
Website: <http://www.tourismlaos.gov.la>



**MALAYSIA**

Ministry of Tourism  
 Menara Dato' Onn  
 Putra World Trade Center, 50480, Kuala Lumpur, Malaysia  
 Tel. (603) 2693 5188 Fax. (603) 269 0207 or 2693 0884  
 Email: [tourism@tourism.gov.my](mailto:tourism@tourism.gov.my)  
 Website: <http://www.tourism.gov.my>

**MYANMAR**

Ministry of Hotels and Tourism  
 Building No. (33), Nay Pyi Taw, Union of Myanmar  
 Tel. 95 67 406129, 406130  
 Email: [mo.moht@mptmail.net.mm](mailto:mo.moht@mptmail.net.mm) / [mohtmail@gmail.com](mailto:mohtmail@gmail.com)  
 Website: <http://www.myanmar-tourism.org/>

**PHILIPPINES**

Department of Tourism  
 DOT Building, T.M. Kalaw Street, Agrifina Circle, Rizal Park  
 Manila 10004, Philippines  
 Tel. (632) 523 8411 Fax. (632) 521 7374  
 Email: [deptour@info.com.ph](mailto:deptour@info.com.ph)  
 Website: <http://www.wowphilippines.com.ph>

**SINGAPORE**

Singapore Tourism Board  
 Tourism Court, 1 Orchard Spring Lane, Singapore  
 247729  
 Tel. (65) 736 6622 Fax. (65) 736 9423  
 Email: [stb\\_sog@stb.gov.sg](mailto:stb_sog@stb.gov.sg)  
 Website: <http://www.yoursingapore.com>

**THAILAND**

Tourism Authority of Thailand  
 1600 New Phetchaburi Road  
 Makkasan, Ratchathewi, Bangkok 10400, Thailand  
 Tel. (662) 250 5500 Fax. (662) 253 7437  
 Email: [center@tat.or.th](mailto:center@tat.or.th)  
 Website: <http://www.tourismthailand.org>

**VIET NAM**

Viet Nam National administration of Tourism  
 80 Quan Su Street, Hanoi, Viet Nam  
 Tel. (84-4) 822 8744 Fax. (84-4) 942 4115  
 Email: [binhvnat@hn.vnn.vn](mailto:binhvnat@hn.vnn.vn)  
 Website: <http://www.vietnamtourism.com>



## ***Tourism Boards***

In some countries such as in Singapore, a 'tourism board' have been established. It is called the Singapore Tourism Board. The primary task of STB was to coordinate the efforts of hotels, airlines and travel agents to develop the fledging tourism industry of the country.

Later, STB began to initiate new marketing ideas to promote Singapore's image abroad. The board created the Merlion, a symbol based on a Singapore mythical legend that became an icon of the Singapore destination. The board also has been providing travel agent licensing and tourist guide training.

STB actively promotes the development of infrastructure, including the building of hotels and tourist attractions such as the Jurong Bird Park and Sentosa which now becomes a popular resort island for both tourists and local visitors. The board also market the city as a convention venue and organised events to attract visitors.



## ***Industry Authorities***

Authorities are established, either by a government or working closely with government to provide services relating to the tourism industry.

One such example is the 'Tourism Authority of Thailand – <http://www.tourismthailand.org>. It is the official travel information website for tourists visiting Thailand and contains all information to ensure visitors have all the necessary information to help them plan and enjoy their travel experience.



## Activity 4 – Identify tourism authorities

For each type of tourism authority listed below, provide examples of actual organisations in which you would request information from.

| Type of tourism authorities | Names of organisations |
|-----------------------------|------------------------|
| Ministries of Tourism       |                        |
| Tourism boards              |                        |
| Industry authorities        |                        |
| Industry associations       |                        |



## ***Printed material***

Practical research requires:

- Generating a personal library of reference material
- Obtaining, reading and taking notes from a range of travel guides
- Obtaining, reading and taking notes from a range of literature
- Obtaining, reading and taking notes from a range of magazines – which may include:
  - Articles from general-purpose publications
  - Travel and tourism-specific magazines
- Gathering and analysing the material contained in advertising brochures and promotional materials – generated by other operators and commercial enterprises.



## ***The general media***

Research involving the general media can involve:

- Watching television programmes and documentaries relating to:
  - Travel and tourism
  - Target countries and cultures
  - Certain aspects of interest relating to identified communities
- Listening to radio interviews – which feature:
  - Indigenous peoples
  - Community leaders
  - Tour Operators and Tour Guides
  - Tourists who have been to target destinations
- Reading eco-tourism community-related articles contained in the Travel and Tourism section or features of newspapers – these may be:
  - Regular columns by reporters and travellers who have visited target destinations
  - Special or 'feature' reports which occur from time-to-time on a range of different countries
  - Articles by industry bodies or government authorities on certain aspects of eco-tourism in different countries.



### ***People from identified communities***

Research activities involving people from identified communities may involve:

- Meeting with them
- Taking to them
- Visiting their communities
- Experiencing their culture
- Participating in local activities
- Recording personal experiences for later analysis
- Taking a tour to a target destination as a tourist on a tour conducted by another Tour Operator.

### ***Industry personnel***

Research activities involving industry personnel can entail:

- Talking with Tour Guides – particularly those who have experience and specialised knowledge of regions and eco-tourism
- Meeting with representatives from peak industry bodies – with the aim of capturing information they already have and referral information they may be able to provide
- Speaking with officers from government agencies and authorities – who have responsibility for Tourism, Culture, Trade or other associated matters and are often able to provide:
  - Valuable statistical information
  - Details of any plans and proposals relating to the target destination
  - Details of incentives to encourage and support tourism activities to target destinations
- Visiting Visitor Information Centres of target communities – in order to:
  - Talk to Information Officers
  - Obtain hard copy, take-away promotional materials produced by local Tour Operators
  - Obtain documentation available from other Tour Operators relating to operational matters – such as sample itineraries, fees and charges, tour schedules, terms and conditions
- Visiting and or talking to support businesses and service providers – to:
  - Gain an idea of the products and services available to enable tours and interpretive activities to be undertaken into the destinations
  - Gauge prices of materials being sold
  - Determine attitude of third party providers towards tourism initiatives into their area
  - Learn about and from their previous experience with Tour Operators and what they have done right or wrong in relation to the community.



## The internet

Using the internet as part of the desk-top research component of the process can involve:

- Undertaking targeted searches
- Accessing publicly released reports and documentation – as prepared by government agencies and industry bodies
- Following-up and gaining additional material on knowledge already obtained from other sources
- Obtaining names of people, places and businesses for subsequent personal or face-to-face contact
- Subscribing to relevant online newsletters and email alerts
- Monitoring relevant eco-tourism travel and tourism blogs and discussion forums or chat rooms.



Following is a list of top 50 ecotourism websites that may be reached at <http://www.airlinecreditcards.com> or travel hacker or top-50-ecotourism-websites.

### "Top 50 Ecotourism Websites"

#### **Organizations and Associations**

*There are numerous organizations worldwide that are dedicated to preserving and protecting the environment while promoting tourism. Here are a few you can get some great information from or even use to get involved.*

1. **VISIT**: VISIT stands for "Voluntary Initiative for Sustainability in Tourism" and this site was created to help tourists and tourist destination countries work together to protect the environment while still making it accessible for everyone.
2. **Tourism Concern**: This organization focuses on issues related to tourism and the environment. You can read up on campaigns and get helpful information for your next trip.
3. **The Travel Foundation**: This charity website can be a great place to find information on how you can better learn to travel without harming the environment. Even if you can't take a trip, you can also get involved and give back through the site.
4. **EcoClub.com**: This international tourism club is a great place to meet up with others interested in ecotourism, find environmentally friendly hotels, and even get links to jobs in ecotourism. Join the site or sign up to receive emails with loads of useful ecotourism information.
5. **International Ecotourism Society**: This worldwide community can help you to learn more about ecotourism, support programs, find ecotourism experts, and locate exciting destinations and environmentally friendly accommodations for your next vacation.

6. **The Blue Flag Organization**: This Foundation for Environmental Education-run site can help you plan your next beach getaway. Blue Flag rates and certifies thousands of beaches in Europe, South Africa, Morocco, New Zealand, Canada and the Caribbean on water quality, environmental management as well as a number of other factors.
7. **The Nature Conservancy**: It's only natural that one of the largest organizations dedicated to preserving nature would have a whole portion of its site dedicated to ecotourism. Learn how to reduce your impact, take trips through the Nature Conservancy, or check out their list of resources to learn more.
8. **The Rainforest Alliance**: Rainforest lovers will find numerous resources on this site about preserving the rainforest, rainforest friendly tours, and even a place where you can adopt a little piece of the rainforest for yourself.
9. **South American Explorers**: This non-profit organization can help you to book your next trip to South America. Whether you want to try out your Spanish in Lima or travel down the Amazon in Brazil, you'll find help on this site to do so all while being ecologically responsible.
10. **World Tourism Organization**: Find out everything you ever wanted to know about tourism on this site. The sustainable tourism section has articles on the latest developments and important issues in ecotourism.
11. **Green Cross International**: According to the mission statement on this site, Green Cross "provides unbiased environmental analysis and expertise, information dissemination, education, objective evaluations for public debate, scientific studies, and social and medical support." This site can be a great way to learn the real statistics of any place you choose to visit.

## Travel Booking

Whether you want to book an exotic rainforest vacation or a camel ride across the Sahara, these sites can help you find a trip that will be both environmentally friendly and fun.

12. **Sustainable Travel International**: On this comprehensive site, you'll find all kinds of ecotourism resources including trip bookings, eco-certification, newsletters and even advice on how to carbon-offset your trip.
13. **ResponsibleTravel.com**: At this site, you'll find loads of great ecologically friendly holiday getaways as well as travel tips, an ecotourism blog, and even an ezine to help keep you informed.
14. **MesoAmerican Ecotourism Alliance**: Recognized for their ecotourism trips by National Geographic, the MEA offers numerous exciting vacations that will help inspire your love for the environment and nurture your adventurous spirit.
15. **GreenStop.net**: GreenStop.net contains a directory of accredited green hotels and travel companies to help make finding and booking your next ecotour easier than ever. With destinations on every continent, you can find sustainable vacations just about anywhere.



16. **EcoTour**: If you want to book an earth-friendly vacation, EcoTour is a great place to start your planning. With hundreds of ecotour providers, you'll find tours to everywhere in the world from the Congo to Sahara. Additionally, you'll find travel guides and articles to help you learn more about your destination of choice.
17. **EcoTourism at Conservation International**: Whether you're looking for an African safari or a trip to the Galapagos, you can find information on how to do so responsibly and even find some very special destinations the organization has helped set up in Brazil, Bolivia, Ghana, Venezuela and more.
18. **EarthFoot**: This small company can help you create a fun and personalized environmentally conscious vacation. See the bright avian residents of Guatemala on a birding getaway or swim with the dolphins in beautiful Hawaii.
19. **GAP Adventures**: Ecotourism doesn't have to be boring. Turn your trip into an unforgettable adventure with this booking site. You can visit the new seven wonders of the world or get up close and personal with the mountain gorillas of Uganda.
20. **Global Exchange**: Global exchange offers what are referred to as "reality tours". Travel to Cambodia to learn about and how you can help stop child prostitution or get informed on protecting the coastal environment of Costa Rica.
21. **Intrepid Travel**: This award winning company specializes in environmentally responsible tourism and can help you arrange your next eco-friendly vacation. With trips to just about every corner of the globe, you'll undoubtedly find something that interests you and won't leave you feeling guilty.
22. **Journeys International**: You'll find a wide variety of small group tours on this family-owned site. Whether your interests lie in trekking through the Andes or exploring the wildlife from the icy decks of an Antarctic cruise, this site has something for you.
23. **Blue Ventures**: Combine education, research and conservation with the trip of a lifetime. This site's tour of Madagascar was named one of the top 50 tours of a lifetime by National Geographic Traveller.
24. **Tribes Travel**: This fair trade travel company offers expeditions to Africa, South America and Asia that can allow you to watch lions sleeping away the day or enjoy an eco-friendly honeymoon in a posh hotel in Marrakech.
25. **Wildland Adventures**: Make your next trip an adventure by booking a safari or trip down the Nile with this small ecotourism company.
26. **Peregrine Adventures**: This Australian based company offers small group adventure tours to destinations worldwide including far-flung locales like the Himalayas and Antarctica.
27. **World Expeditions**: Get adventurous without hurting the environment with this ecotourism company. Book trips to volcanic landscapes, the lemur filled jungles of Madagascar or follow in the steps of Genghis Khan on the Mongolian Steppes.
28. **Earth Routes**: Find your next earth-friendly vacation through this site. You'll find tours to the Caribbean, Switzerland and even a few small ship cruises as well as travel tips and green travel information.

29. **Orbitz.com**: Orbitz isn't one of the biggest travel sites without a reason: they offer travel tailored to just about any need, even ecotourism. You'll find a list of destinations, information about ecotourism, travel tips and more on this part of Orbitz's site.

## Blogs

Blogs are becoming an ever more popular source of information for Internet users, and these ecotourism blogs can be a great way to learn about everything eco-friendly.

30. **Ecotourism Blog**: This blog covers some of the most beautiful destinations in the world in regard to protecting and preserving them as well as reporting on various news stories that apply to ecotourism.
31. **EcoTravelLogue**: This blog provides all kinds of information for the potential eco-traveller with posts on destinations, planning a trip, accommodation, things to do, and more.
32. **Development Crossing**: Whether you're looking for information on global warming or issues concerning ecotourism, this environmentally conscious blog addresses it all.
33. **Beautiful Oceans**: If your ecotourism dreams lie in the coral reefs or kelp forests of the world's oceans, then you'll find plenty to read about here. Learn about reef conservation, eco-diving, and even a little bit about underwater photography.
34. **Low Impact Living**: Focusing on all aspects of low impact living, this blog contains some great information on vacations that won't take a toll on the environment. Learn about organic eating, green spas, hybrid car rentals, environmentally friendly hotels, and more.

## Information and Guides

Before you ever leave your home, read up on all kinds of ecotourism tips, facts and other information on these great sites.

35. **EcoHoliday Guide**: Find tons of resources for planning your next eco-trip on this site. You'll find information on environmentally conscious vacation rentals, travel agents, activities, transport, and even places to eat.
36. **World Surface**: This online travel magazine was created to promote sustainable tourism and is contributed to by writers and photographers from all over the globe. Visitors to the site will find information on tons of destinations and can create their own travel diaries and photo albums to share with other travellers.
37. **Planeta**: Find resources on ecotourism, recommendations on books, and guides on everything from bird watching to local crafts on this site.
38. **GreenTraveller**: Get some great tips on how to have a greener and more environmentally friendly holiday at GreenTraveller. You'll find directories of green hotels, tours, and low impact ways to travel to them.
39. **Eco-Index: Sustainable Tourism**: Here you'll find a list of businesses in Latin America and the Caribbean that have been certified to be environmentally friendly. It can be a great way to protect the beautiful rainforests and beaches of these destinations while making sure they stay that way.



40. **EcoTravel.com**: This online magazine features stories from all over the world about the most exciting ecotourist destinations. It also features a directory of tour companies and agents to help you book your next trip.
41. **Transitions Abroad**: This site addresses a wide variety of travel issues, but it does contain a valuable section on ecotourism. You'll find responsible travel programs and article archives, as well as links to important websites and organizations.
42. **NewConsumer**: This UK based magazine is dedicated to stories about how you can live a more ethically, vacations included. Check out the travel section for articles on environmentally friendly vacation ideas all over the world.
43. **Big Volcano Ecotourism Resource Center**: Find information on the history of ecotourism, codes of conduct, and loads of other ecotourism articles and resources on this site.
44. **Best Ecotourism Vacations**: Not sure where you want to head to? Get some ideas of the best and most popular ecotourism destinations in this article from SmarterTravel.

### Volunteering

Take ecotourism to the next level with these sites that allow you to get your hands dirty working on various humanitarian and environmental projects all over the world.

45. **GoEco**: This organization arranges volunteer trips to South Africa, Kenya, Nepal and much more to help improve the welfare of the local people and the environment.
46. **EcoVolunteer**: Just like the name suggests, this site helps set travellers up on various volunteering vacations, and users can choose their trips based on preferred destinations or particular animals they are interested in helping.
47. **Global Vision**: Make a difference in some of the world's locations that are in most desperate need of conservation help. Work at preserving marine environments, do wildlife research or even help teach others about conservation and wildlife.
48. **Voluntourists Without Borders**: Use your volunteer power and vacation time to work on issues involving rural poverty, conservation and environmentally friendly tourism. Work to help preserve the Pang Soong Nature Trails or the village of Ban Mae Lai.
49. **People and Places**: On this site, you'll find a diverse assortment of volunteer projects that range from wildlife conservation in India to building Habitat for Humanity houses in Madagascar.
50. **Green Volunteers**: With one of the largest collections of conservation volunteering opportunities, this site is be a valuable resource for those who want to provide a little environmental help on their vacation. Just purchase the guide and choose your exciting vacation from hundreds of options"



## Activity 5 – Identify 5 key sources of information



You are required to identify the five key sources of information that you have found useful in obtaining information relating to eco-tourism attractions in your region.

| SOURCE OF INFORMATION | NAME OF ORGANISATION or SOURCE | USEFUL INFORMATION FOUND |
|-----------------------|--------------------------------|--------------------------|
|                       |                                |                          |
|                       |                                |                          |
|                       |                                |                          |
|                       |                                |                          |
|                       |                                |                          |

## Identify requirements of the eco-tourism tour or activity to be conducted

Whilst it is essential to understand all aspects of eco-tourism issues, in reality it is not realistic or practical to have a thorough understanding of every eco-tourism issue relating to your region.

Therefore it is important that as a minimum requirement that you are well versed in the areas and activities that will make up part of the eco-tourism tour or activity you are to conduct.

Those with responsibility for preparing interactive tour activities, content and commentaries can identify what is needed through a combination of the following activities:

- Reading advertising or promotional materials for the tour – which will describe the type, nature and focus of the tour
- Reading the customer itinerary for the tour – which will present details of where the tour is going and what is happening. This includes information relating to routes, modes of transport, destinations, attractions, activities and other inclusions, timing provisions, accommodation, catering and other tour-specific matters
- Joining the tours already developed – as a tour group member to experience what is currently being said and done
- Talking to other tour guides – to learn from them about what they do and say
- Obtaining a copy of the script being currently used – to see the information already being conveyed
- Speaking with management – to determine their wants, needs and expectations regarding content of the commentary
- Using personal knowledge of the tour route and destination inclusions coupled with common sense to determine what should be communicated in terms of:
  - The type of tour being conducted
  - Local events, conditions and occurrences
- Reading feedback from past tour group members – to identify:
  - What they liked and disliked
  - What they wanted but did not receive
  - Areas about which they wanted more or different information
- Taking other tours provided by competitors or other tour operators – to see what they do and listen to their commentaries, analyse their content, note their timing and other presentation techniques



- Speaking with organisational staff who worked with the client to secure the tour and determine the deal – to find out:
  - What they promised
  - What they learned from the client
  - Interpretation of nuances they identified when speaking with the client
- Reading the contract for the tour – one-off tours will be based on a written contract which sets out the responsibilities on the Tour Operator based on the promises they have made
- Talking to management – who may have specific additional requirements regarding the tour to be delivered based on:
  - Personal preferences regarding how they want the tour delivered
  - Information they gained as part of the overall negotiation process
- Contacting expected tour group members – to identify what they want covered by the commentary.



## 1.3 Determine customer interests and potential themes for possible interpretive activities

### Introduction

In the previous section we have looked at the various sources of eco-tourism information.

In this section we will focus on the needs and interests of customers when selecting eco-tourism tourism or activities.

### Finding out needs of the customer

It is essential to talk to the customer to identify:

- Their needs, wants and preferences
- Critical aspects or topics which must be covered
- Type or nature of the information required – for example, historic detail, comparative information, current statistics
- Who the people in the tour group will be – that is, obtaining a profile for the tour group including age, gender, interests, background, existing knowledge or experience.



### Understand customer requests and needs

In some situations customer requests and needs will be significant factors in the development of interpretive activities and the approach to guiding.

In general, most standard tours are offered on an 'as is' basis.

This means in practice there is little, if any, departure from the advertised itinerary as the conduct of these tours 'as planned' is necessary in order for the tour to:

- Start and finish tours at scheduled times
- Integrate the operation of the tour with other activities undertaken by other operators who are part of tour inclusions
- Meet obligations to or expectations of other businesses that are associated with the planned running of the tour.



Special requirements for tours which may impact interpretive guiding will take one of two forms:

- A Private or Custom tour – these are tours:
  - Developed under contract with a client
  - Customised on a one-off basis
  - Designed specifically and totally to meet the identified needs of the individual client
  - Run at a time and date determined by the client
- Special requests received from members of a tour party – which:
  - May be received in advance of the tour date – or received on-the-day at the pre-tour briefing
  - The Tour Operator has agreed to accommodate – many special requests will not be able to be accommodated as they raise unacceptable issues related to:
    - Timing
    - Costs
    - Safety.

## Examples of special requests

Customer requests and needs in relation to interpretive activities and the interpretative approach taken to tours can relate to:

- Timing
- Budget
- Location of the interpretive activity
- Access to interpretive activities
- Specific activities
- Information
- Level of engagement
- Variations.



### ***Timing considerations***

These can relate to:

- Changing date of tour
- Altering start and/or finish time or s for tour
- Amending start and/or finish time of activities
- Extending or shortening tours and/or activities
- Integrating or matching the tour and/or activities with other tours, activities or considerations.

### ***Budget considerations***

These can relate to:

- Making more money available
- Decreasing funds available
- Re-allocating money within the tour budget – from one activity or aspect to another.

Possible impacts may be:

- Allocating more staff to the tour or to activities within the tour
- Allocating more hours to the standard staffing roster for a tour
- Making more money available to the tour or to tour activities so that:
  - Additional activities can be included
  - More detailed or less extensive activities can be included
  - Activities can occur for a longer period or must be shorter
  - Activities can engage with more or fewer people
- Changing type of activities to be conducted or type of interpretive approach to be taken – depending on whether funds are increased or decreased.



### ***Location considerations***

These can relate to:

- Changing locations so activities are conducted on-site rather than on-the-bus
- Including sites and locations which were previously or normally not included as part of the tour
- Moving standard activities from inside to an outside location where there is more engagement with the environment, site or people or community
- Making participants more comfortable by shifting activities from outside to an air conditioned venue
- Revising times when visitations to certain destinations takes place – to enable integration with nominated other activities.



### ***Access considerations***

These can relate to:

- Being able to gain access to sites not previously accessed – as a result of extra money available for entry, travel or compensation to local communities
- Reorganising standard activities so there are better lines of sight and hearing regarding the interpretive activity
- Driving tour vehicles closer to activity points – meaning tour group parties have to walk less distance



- Including access to areas and facilities not normally used on tours
- Gaining earlier access to sites
- Being able to stay longer at sites
- Increasing durations of stays.

### ***Specific activity considerations***

These can relate to:

- Altering the nature of activities to be included within the tour
- Extending or reducing length and scope of activities
- Providing more detail for activities
- Allowing more people to participate in activities
- Re-locating an activity
- Re-positioning an activity in the itinerary for the tour.

### ***Information considerations***

These can relate to:

- Changing the type or amount of content of information and or interpretation provided for an activity
- Linking an activity to a designated topic
- Providing more handout material
- Using different presenters to deliver information
- Making nominated topics the constant focus (a 'thread' or theme for the tour) throughout all tour activities.

### ***Level of engagement considerations***

These can relate to:

- Providing base information and materials to tour group participants in advance of the tour – so they can gain pre-tour knowledge
- Increasing the number of activities included in the tour
- Converting passive activities to active ones
- Incorporating time for reflection and feedback
- Facilitating intra-group discussions.

## Variation considerations

In addition to what has already been presented above these can relate to:

- Changing interpretive activities to meet specific tour group characteristics – such as:
  - The age of tour group members
  - Mobility of participants
  - Special needs
- Altering catering – to:
  - Include refreshments or meals not normally included
  - Accommodate special diets or religious or cultural requirements
  - Meet revised timelines of changed itinerary
  - Keep groups together
- Amending inclusions – which could mean:
  - Substituting activities, destinations or attractions
  - Changing modes of transport
  - Adding merchandise
  - Incorporating guest speakers, competitions, prizes
  - Involving or facilitating media contact to promote the tour.



## Develop theme and message

Before developing an eco-tour or activity the tour guide needs to know about any identified, required or promised themes and messages that tour group members are expecting from the tour as this impacts significantly on how an interpretive activity will be presented.

Important points to note regarding 'theme and message' are:

- The terms 'message' and 'theme' are often used interchangeably but do have separate meanings
- A 'message' (sometimes more properly known as an 'interpretive message') is an uncomplicated stand-alone but important statement which makes sense on its own but nonetheless underpins and supports the theme for an activity – for example, 'Modern civilisation can cause adverse impacts on local communities'
- The 'theme' for the activity or the tour is often referred to as 'the take home message' for the visitors – the use of the word 'message' in this commonly used definition is partly responsible for the confusion that exists regarding distinction between the two terms
- The take home message is one, big idea that the tour or activity wants people to leave with or thinking about
- There is no limit to the exact nature of the 'messages and themes' which may be developed



- ‘Messages and themes’ may be seen as the story-lines for activities
- There may be a single message or theme, or multiple story-lines, included as part of an interpretive activity.

## Example of developing themes

In answer to the question ‘What’s a theme?’ the Interpretation Planning Workbook (California State Parks, 2013) [available at <http://www.parks.ca.gov/pages/735/files/InterpPlanningWorkbookWEB2013.pdf>] offers, in part, (pp 37 – 39):

*“The best interpretation is characterized by a clear sense of purpose. Theme statements provide a point-of-view or an approach to a particular subject. They are concise. The best theme is a simple, complete idea that defines the informational scope and the perspective to be offered. Interpretive themes offer a bridge for visitors to help them understand the significant natural, cultural, and recreational resources of a park.”*

*“A **unifying theme** or overall theme is used when planning park visitor centres or multi-subject exhibits. The unifying theme provides a conceptual focus and general approach for the interpretive offerings. It establishes the overall tone and direction and implies the desired outcome interpretation should have on visitors’ attitudes and perspectives. The unifying theme is presented through the interpretation of the primary, secondary, and supporting themes.”*

*“**Primary themes** define the most essential ideas, like the chapters in a book. Primary themes carry the common thread of the unifying theme to tell a complete story.”*

*“**Supporting themes** (also called subthemes) provide more detailed perspectives on one or more of the primary themes.”*

*“**Secondary themes** provide valuable, but non-essential information related to the unifying and primary themes. Like sidebars or footnotes in an article, secondary themes may be only tangentially related to the unifying theme.”*

And:

- “Themes must relate to visitor interests, the resources and the mission of the park
- Themes need a clear point of view expressed as a simple statement or question
- Themes should show relationships and processes—not just facts
- Individual themes should contribute to a memorable “take home” message (the unifying theme)
- While themes should not be just facts, they must be accurate
- Have all themes reviewed by subject matter experts.”

## Considerations when developing themes

It is necessary to ensure the messages and themes, regardless of what they are or how many there are, being considered for conversion into an interpretive activity within a tour:

### ***Support and align with identified objectives***

As determined by:

- Tour type and advertisements or promises made about the tour and its inclusions and activities
- Requests or specifications from the client or tour group
- Identified previous knowledge or experiences of the tour group
- Negotiations with local communities – regarding:
  - Issues to be addressed
  - Material and content which can be used or disclosed
  - Economic and employment targets
- Internal operating constraints and imperatives – such as:
  - Time
  - Staffing
  - Costs
  - Travel options
  - Quality assurance and professionalism
  - Safety and risk management
  - Actions being taken by competitors in the marketplace
- Compliance requirements – as imposed by:
  - Mandated legal obligations
  - Local agreements
  - Codes of Practice, Conduct and Ethics to which the Tour Operator subscribes.



### ***Be approved***

By:

- The employer – for inclusion on the tour schedule and authorised as suitable for intended use
- The wider community– in terms of general acceptability
- The specific local communities - to ensure it meets their needs and matches their expectations
- Relevant authorities – who may want to:
  - Address a variety of local issues and sensitivities

- Check compliance with local accords
- Sign-off on integration of the activity with other regional initiatives and or tourism-related plans and strategies.

### ***Integrate and align with the interpretive approach to guiding***

In terms of:

- Explaining and interpreting what is being presented
- Encouraging thinking and reflection
- Providing context (history, heritage and culture) for the themes and messages
- Comparing and contrasting facts and detail
- Being respectful
- Enriching the tour and the experiences of the tour party.



### ***Factor in the expected delivery environment***

Such as:

- At a nature-based site
- At a cultural site
- In a national park
- On a walking tour
- On a cruise.

### ***Comply with required and expected business principles and ethical standards***

Which must address:

- Requirements for the full truth to be conveyed – and for opinion and supposition to be identified and separated from ‘fact’
- Full disclosure – including the negative aspects of a message or theme
- No ‘massaging’ or ‘spinning’ of the truth
- A complete absence of fabrication of information
- Need for accurate and comprehensive information and data.

## Writing a theme

Sometimes the 'theme' is already written and sometimes there is a need to generate one.

Identifying and understanding a clearly defined theme is vital as it:

- Underpins the next stage of the process – developing the activities necessary to deliver the theme
- Provides a focal point for the tour group – which must be engaging, entertaining or thought-provoking.



## Themes for interpretive activities

The potential list of themes covered by interactive activities is endless. In practice, different groups have different needs, wants and preferences.

All tours will need to address more than one theme.

The one thing all commentaries have in common is they will all relate directly to the nature, objectives and subject of the tour.

Themes which may be the focus of interpretive eco-tourism guiding and activities include:

- Flora, including types, history, concentrations, growth patterns, threats, seasonal influences, preservation and conservation issues
- History and heritage of the general area with attention to special items or areas of interest
- The general natural environment
- The built environment, including its impact on the eco-system
- Individual species, including their history, current context and predicted future, foods, predatory inclinations, habitats, mating habits, life cycle and threats
- Specific geographic locations and landmarks
- Feedback from customers and co-workers suggesting topics for activities
- Initiatives recommended by local authorities and local communities
- Topics of general community interest.





## Activity 6 - Identify eco-tourism themes

You are required to develop a number of eco-tourism themes which may be the basis for a tour or range of activities that can be promoted and provided to customers coming to your region.



Consider your themes taking into account eco-tourism attractions in your region that may appeal to prospective customers.

**It is important to note that the themes identified in this activity, will be the focus of all activities for the remainder of this manual.**

| THEME                          | KEY ASPECTS OF THEME       |
|--------------------------------|----------------------------|
| Geographical location - forest | Fauna<br>Flora<br>Wildlife |
|                                |                            |
|                                |                            |
|                                |                            |
|                                |                            |
|                                |                            |
|                                |                            |



## 1.4 Use research techniques to obtain information

### Introduction

In order for interpretive activities and associated content to be effective there is a non-negotiable need for Tour Guides to research the subject that is the focus of the activity.

This section identifies a range of techniques to acquire information which can be used in interpretive activities and presents tips to optimise research which is conducted.

### Importance of obtaining and verifying complete information

A common mistake made by those who are new to the Tour guide business is for them to assume they already know the information that needs to be provided as part of a tour commentary.

New tour guides frequently rely simply on their local, general knowledge believing it will be sufficient to enable them to provide:

- What is required
- To the standard required
- In order to meet customer and management expectations.

The reality is usually very different to this.

Most commentaries require:

- Coverage of more topics than most people know about
- More detail than most people commonly have in their general knowledge
- Updating of information to make it current.



### Need for research

To gain the information, detail and currency needed for most tour commentaries there is a non-negotiable need for Tour Guides to:

- Undertake targeted research – of identified topics
- Use a combination of research options to gain their knowledge
- Take notes – as they do their research so they can capture:
  - The required facts and detail identified – for later reference when generating the script for the commentary
  - Details of the sources they used to obtain this information – so these sources can be re-visited in the future to up-date information.

## Basic requirements for researched information

Not all types of research will generate the required type of information for use in tour commentaries.

It is essential all facts and information obtained as a result of the research process align with the criteria which require them to be:

- Relevant
- Correct and accurate
- Comprehensive
- Current, where applicable.



## Collect primary and secondary data

Whilst the word 'information' has been used in this manual to date, in effect this is the collective term for 'data' that has been collected.

Data is a piece of information that can be collected and interpreted by an organisation for their use.

Naturally data that is specifically aimed to help an organisation is the most desirable, it is not always possible for an organisation to collect its own information.

So what types of data can be collected and used by a tourism organisation?

The two most common sources of data are:

- Primary data – collected for a specific purpose
- Secondary data – generic information.



### **Primary data**

Primary research data is newly generated research information that you yourself or the organisation create, as opposed to the existing secondary data. The need for primary research data commonly arises because of gaps in the information available through the secondary research data.

### **Secondary data**

Secondary data is information that already exists. It just needs to be found. A business can generate secondary research data from its sales figures, databases and from other peak bodies who have already undertaken primary research and published the results of that research.

Secondary data sources should be exhausted before primary research is undertaken. It must be relevant, accurate and sufficient. It is less expensive than primary research, easily accessible and immediately available.

## Research options

A combination of research options always produces the best results.

Researching the selected commentary information could include a need to combine several of the following approaches:

### ***Reading site and location specific information sources***

As provided by brochures, flyers, marketing materials and promotional leaflets produced by:

- Destinations
- Attractions
- Businesses
- Activities
- Local tourism bodies
- Government tourism agencies.



### ***Talking and listening to relevant people***

- Visiting communities which will be visited on the tour or discussed on the tour and interacting with them, where applicable and where possible
- Learning from 'site guides' who work at destinations or locations to be visited – these are the private tour guides employed by the site or attractions just to deliver tours for that specific site or location and nothing else – they always have extensive information about the place where they work
- Speaking with key people from the local tourism agency, bureau or government agency – as these people always have:
  - Good local knowledge
  - Access to lots of supporting data and sources
  - Contacts which can assist with other research
- Talking to other Tour Guides – this approach should include conversing with:
  - Other Tour Guides from within the host Tour Operator organisation
  - Tour Guides employed by other Tour Operators
  - Private or self-employed Tour Guides.



### ***Consulting with local communities***

- Talking and listening to relevant people – such as:
  - Managers
  - Owners
  - Other Tour Guides
  - Tour group members
- Visiting communities – and:
  - Interacting with the people
  - Using the infrastructure
  - Mixing with society
  - Experiencing the environment
- Holding community meetings – in order to:
  - Facilitate discussions with local communities, Elders and representatives
  - Meet key stakeholders
  - Identify local issues as identified by the community
  - Determine what can and cannot or what should and should not be included and communicated as part of tours and interpretive activities.



### ***Organising information from personal memory and personal experiences***

This highlights:

- Personal knowledge and experience is a *legitimate* source of knowledge
- Doing this helps identify:
  - Gaps in knowledge which need to be addressed
  - Topics which needs to be up-dated
  - Information which needs to be checked and verified – personal memory has a habit of not being all that reliable.

### ***Monitoring the media***

- Reading travel and tourism sections of newspapers and magazines
- Noting articles and advertisements in newspapers indicating new businesses, changes in circumstances, industry-related innovations
- Listening to local radio to note matters and happenings and occurrences of current interest and changes to previous conditions or circumstances
- Watching the television – to see travel and tourism programs and relevant documentaries
- Reading books and other targeted reference sources.



## ***Undertaking internet desktop research***

This can include visiting and downloading information from web sites of:

- Destinations and attractions
- Government agencies or tourism authority
- Targeted web sites containing required information, as identified during the previous process
- Watching videos of other Tour Guides conducting their tours – as recorded by tour group members and posted on the 'Net.

## ***Touring and travelling***

- Participating in other tours and interpretive activities conducted by the employer tour organisation – to:
  - Get a first-hand idea of what other activities are being included in tours by other Guides and businesses
  - Identify and experience a variety of approaches being used by other Tour Guides in relation to interpretive guiding
- Taking part in tours and interpretive activities operated by other tour organisations – in the local area and in more remote locations to obtain personal experience of their techniques and topics in relation to interpretive guiding
- Visiting museums and cultural centres and holding discussions with curators – to help gain information and context for commentaries and for inclusions in tours and interpretive activities.



## ***Joining***

This requires:

- Becoming an active member of a local Guiding or Interpretive Guiding industry association – and engaging with what they have to offer in terms of training, research and educational materials and meetings
- Making contact with the local industry-operated, tourism-related peak body – and becoming involved in their activities to promote and engage with local communities
- Making contact with tourism-related government agencies and authorities – and attending their meetings, registering to receive newsletter and contributing to their deliberations and discussions regarding tourism, local communities and interpretive guiding.



## Keys in undertaking effective research

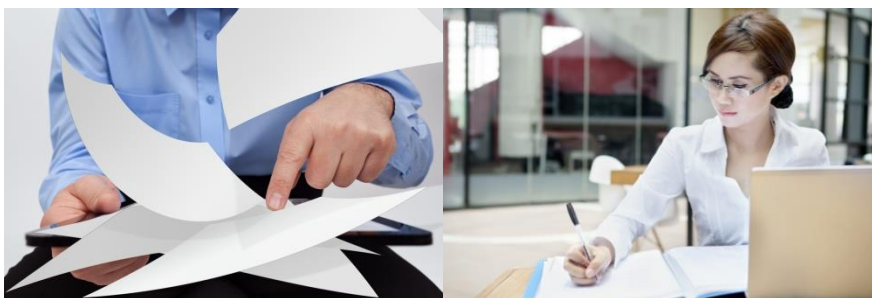
It is important to:

- Ask questions – as part of the research process to gain extra information to supplement the information available
- Make notes – and not rely on memory
- Ensure the sources of all information are recorded – so it is easier to refer back when a need to do so arises
- Read and review – the information which has been obtained
- Organise information for reference and research purposes – from personal memory and personal experiences
- Validate the information gained – by checking it with authoritative sources and local communities
- Obtain necessary permissions – to use material which has been captured
- Check back with the client– to ensure the information obtained addresses the content of what they want covered
- Update the research – so materials stays current and new information is constantly being acquired.



### ***Activity 7 - Conduct research***

Based on the themes you have identified in Activity 6, you are required to conduct research on your themes with the aim of being able to develop interpretive content for a tour.





## 1.5 Verify information that has been gathered

### Introduction

When research has been conducted, the facts and figures which have been identified will need to be properly assembled for further development and use.

Once basic information has been obtained there is a need for it to be further processed by assembling it in accordance with identified customer need for the tour to be conducted.

It is imperative there is a strong and direct link between the information provided in a commentary and the identified need of the tour client.

Once relevant information searched and identified, it must be filed for future use as deemed most appropriate by the enterprise and in-keeping with any relevant policies and procedures.

In essence, you have to decide how and where to keep the information you have gathered, and will continue to gather.

Every tourism operator will have their own method of filing and storing information. It is important to know where to look for certain pieces of information.

Your office will have a system of filing all information so that it is easy to retrieve. Check and make sure that you understand how the information is organised so that you can source it readily. It may be that your computer system is a sophisticated one and can handle the storage of all or most of the information. This may be supplemented by filing cabinets and manuals.



Options are few and a simple, basic system tends to be preferred over a high-tech one: computer based 'data retrieval systems' tend not to be customer friendly and there is always the risk that not every staff member will be able to use them. In addition, they need to be updated as new information is sourced or they quickly become relatively useless as a source of useful and reliable information.

In addition, someone has to enter the information in the first place, which can be a time consuming and expensive undertaking.

It is imperative that all information stored is totally up to date at all times. You must provide customers with current information. There should be a system to regularly cull and replace old documents and information.

This section looks at the basis for classifying information which may be used when material has been captured as a result of the research process.

### Options for storing information

Information storage systems may be:

- Manual filing systems
- Computerised systems
- Combination of the above.



Regardless of the system used, it is important to remember that the focus of capturing and storing information is to use it as part of the service delivery and to improve operational efficiency.



## Considerations when storing information

There are a number of considerations that must be taken into account, regardless of which system is used, including:

- Timing of data entry and up-dates, including up-date schedules
- Authorities to enter data, including designation of individuals and positions within the business
- Identification of specific data that must and must not be entered onto the system
- Complying with operational requirements of the data system, including log on procedures, system integrity, fields to be used, file creation procedures, file naming protocols and system security requirements
- Version controls to note dates material was last edited or up-dated.



## Classifying information

Once the process of establishing and maintaining paper-based and electronic storage and retrieval systems, as seen above, has been identified it is now time to determine how information will be classified.

The process of classifying information includes:

- Preserving actual samples
- Organising facts into discrete sections
- Arranging information under nominated headings
- Ordering statistics in date or time sequence
- Contrasting one set of data to another set for the purposes of comparison
- Grouping similar facts and details
- Indexing the information obtained – for filing reasons and future reference.





# Activity 8 – Classify and store information

Based on the themes you have researched in Activity 7, you are required to explain the information you have gathered and how you are to categorise and store the information.

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## 1.6 Verify information that has been gathered

### Introduction

Once you have captured information that has been collect or given to you by various sources and organisations it is now time to review and verify the information and determine its importance, accuracy and relevancy for tours to be conducted.

In essence reviewing and verifying information is aimed at determining and accuracy and appropriateness of the information in meeting the needs of the organisation and potential clients.

### Objectives of reviewing and verifying captured information

Objectives of reviewing and verifying information that you have captured include:

- Confirming the applicability and utility of material researched and provided
- Determining degree of usefulness of the information
- Confirming accuracy, currency and relevancy of information
- Validating contested pieces of information with authorities and relevant others
- Obtaining credible evidence to support the integrity of information collected
- Ensuring that no obvious sources of information have been overlooked
- Meeting with the information user to check that the material gathered is appropriate for their needs
- Checking with local communities and stakeholders to confirm or deny research material
- Determining if additional information, material or data is required to meet identified needs.



### Interpret information

Interpreting information takes it one step further and explores the content of the information which can be used by the organisation and improve content provided during an eco-tourism event.

It is essential that you are able to interpret and understand the information so that you are able to use it appropriately communicate this information to clients accurately and professionally.

## Purpose of interpreting information

This serves a number of purposes including:

- Gaining further understanding of the information
- Identifying any questions you may have
- Identify the key points in which you may convey to stakeholders, colleagues or clients.

## Identify possible information needs

When interpreting information it is a good idea to see where improvements can be made to help provide evidence or proof or findings. Try to look at the results of your research with a critical eye to determine:

- Is the evidence complete, or is more information required?
- Do you need to collect more data?
- Are there any mistakes, irregularities or conflicting evidence in findings?

Once information has been reviewed, categorised and interpreted in a logical and methodical manner, information can be provided to clients in a logical manner.



### ***Activity 9 – Identify importance of verifying information***

Explain the importance of verifying the information you have collected in Activity 7.

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Explain how you can verify the information you have collected in Activity 7 to ensure it is accurate.

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## 1.7 Learn the required information to support identified eco-tourism concepts, themes and focal points

### Introduction

In the previous section we have explored the process of collecting, verifying and interpreting information that can be used as part of commentary and content of interpretive activities scheduled for an eco-tourism activity or tour.

Not all information a tour guide needs to know can, or will, fit into a scripted tour commentary.

In addition, based on the process of verifying and interpreting information, further information may need to be gathered.

This section highlights the need for tour guides to acquire additional information and suggests ways they can gather and learn it.



### Need to gather and learn extra information

As identified earlier the total commentary for a tour will comprise a scripted commentary supplemented by ancillary information.

The ancillary information is required in order to enable the tour guide to:

- Paint more context for the tour
- Describe additional features and information
- Answer questions asked by tour group members
- Provide extra detail emerging as required for individual parties
- Demonstrate professionalism
- Help build personal credibility
- Promote certain businesses, activities or regions associated with the tour
- Expand on information supplied as part of the scripted commentary
- Meet tour party expectations by satisfying individual need.



## Ways to learn extra information

The following practices have proven to be effective ways for tour guides to gather and learn the supplementary information they need to know in order to provide a rounded and comprehensive 'total package' when delivering tour commentaries:

### ***Actively studying the material generated***

This involves reading and re-reading facts and information.

### ***Conducting test activities***

Where the learner tests themselves by:

- Posing questions to themselves and generating model answers
- Developing and completing a series of targeted test questions
- Role plays – where other Tour Operator staff play the role of tour group members and the learner responds to their random questions.



### ***Writing additional scripts***

For:

- Supplementary tours covering the same routes, destinations, inclusions, topics and themes
- Tours covering different themes for the same itinerary
- Tours on the same them(s) but of differing durations.

This process is extremely effective in reinforcing the information and 'forcing' the Tour Guide to view the same material in different ways, and to integrate it with different facts or pieces of information.

### ***Creating alternate presentation options***

This can be done for delivering the same information such as:

- Using prop kits instead of verbal descriptions
- Developing anecdotes to cover nominated topics
- Applying a range of different interpretive guiding practices.



### Updating personal knowledge

This can be done on the basis of:

- Reviewing and revising the script on a regular basis to determine what remains 'in the script' and what needs to be classified as 'ancillary information'
- Fresh market research or customer feedback indicating changed requirements in terms of the information required by tour group members from the scripted commentary they receive
- Emerging data, facts, knowledge, statistics, trends and other relevant information appropriate to the tour type or tour themes
- Personal experience gained from on-going formal and informal research, events arising and individual interactions.



### Activity 10 - Identify need for further information learning

Based on the information you have collected and reviewed in Activities 7&9, identify what further information you may need to gather to help improve the interpretive content you will provide to customers.

| FURTHER INFORMATION REQUIRED | METHOD OF COLLECTING INFORMATION |
|------------------------------|----------------------------------|
|                              |                                  |
|                              |                                  |
|                              |                                  |
|                              |                                  |



## Work Projects

It is a requirement of this Unit you complete Work Projects as advised by your Trainer. You must submit documentation, suitable evidence or other relevant proof of completion of the project to your Trainer by the agreed date.

1.1 Please complete the following activities relating to this Performance Criteria:

- Activities 1,2

1.2 Please complete the following activities relating to this Performance Criteria:

- Activities 3,4,5

1.3 Please complete the following activities relating to this Performance Criteria:

- Activity 6

1.4 Please complete the following activities relating to this Performance Criteria:

- Activity 7

1.5 Please complete the following activities relating to this Performance Criteria:

- Activity 8

1.6 Please complete the following activities relating to this Performance Criteria:

- Activity 9

1.7 Please complete the following activities relating to this Performance Criteria:

- Activity 10
-

# Summary

## Research information

### Describe the interpretive approach to guiding and activities

- Definition of eco-tourism
- Interpretive guiding
- Interpretive techniques
- Commentaries
- Factors which might provide the context
- Key features of interpretive guiding
- Need to understand interpretive activity plans
- POETRY
- Fifteen Principles of Interpretation.

### Identify sources of information for eco-tourism knowledge

- Sources of information
- Relevant peak preservation and conservation bodies:
  - Ministries of Tourism
  - Tourism Boards
  - Industry Authorities
  - Printed material
  - The general media
  - People from identified communities
  - Industry personnel
  - The internet
- Identify requirements of the eco-tourism tour or activity to be conducted.

### Determine customer interests and potential themes for possible interpretive activities

- Finding out needs of the customer
- Understand customer requests and needs
- Examples of special requests
- Develop theme and message
- Example of developing themes
- Considerations when developing themes
- Writing a theme
- Themes for interpretive activities.

**Use research techniques to obtain information**

- Importance of obtaining and verifying complete information
- Need for research
- Basic requirements for researched information
- Collect primary and secondary data
- Research options
- Keys in undertaking effective research.

**Classify and store information**

- Options for storing information
- Considerations when storing information
- Classifying information.

**Verify information that has been gathered**

- Objectives of reviewing and verifying captured information
- Interpret information
- Purpose of interpreting information
- Identify possible information needs.

**Learn the required information to support identified eco-tourism concepts, themes and focal points**

- Need to gather and learn extra information
- Ways to learn extra information.

## Element 2:

# Prepare an eco-tourism activity

## 2.1 Develop and determine concepts, themes and focal points for potential eco-tourism activities

## 3.4 Create new activities

### Introduction

In Section 1.3 of this manual, the different types of possible themes for an eco-tourism interpretive tour or activity have been identified.

In this section we will explore in more detail the process of expanding on initial themes and developing objectives and activities for themes selected.

### Key points of determining and creating activities

Develop and determine themes and associated activities may include:

- Prioritising options that have been identified
- Evaluating practicality of implementing available options, including impact, cost, sensitivity, timing, safety and sustainability issues
- Planning physical and ancillary requirements to deliver selected options
- Setting specific objectives for each eco-tourism activity.

### Objectives of interpretive activities

Flowing from the themes identified in Section 1.3 of this manual, will be the objectives of the tour which also have to be taken into account when researching and preparing the commentary.

Possible objectives for the tour group can include:

- Education
- Experience
- Relaxation
- Fun
- Excitement
- Celebration of an event or historical date
- Money raising – for a person, club or organisation
- Recreation.



Once again, an individual tour can have multiple objectives which need to be accommodated.

## Setting objectives for each eco-tourism activity

A standard requirement for all interpretive activities and guiding is there is a purpose or objective for what occurs. In addition to the general objectives mentioned above, additional specific objectives, relating to individual activities or locations may need to be developed.

Specific objectives for interpretive activities may relate to:

### ***Educational, historical or cultural issues***

For:

- Groups – such as:
  - School children
  - Students of a particular region, culture or aspect
  - Special interest groups
- Individual people within tour groups – who may have:
  - Previous experience or engagement with the community
  - Knowledge of other different communities
  - Knowledge of other similar communities.



### ***Commercial imperatives***

Which can be related to:

- The need for the individual tour to deliver the activities and experiences which were advertised in the promotion material for the scheduled tour being conducted
- Necessity for the tour to:
  - Meet contracted requirements of a custom or private tour
  - Align with the tour schedule and itinerary negotiated with the local community
  - Provide the agreed retail opportunities to the communities being visited.



### ***Social agendas***

As they relate to:

- The needs of the tour group
- The needs of the local community.

### ***Content of the tour***

As this relates to:

- Identification of specific themes to be contained within the interpretive guiding experience being presented
- Information to be communicated within each interpretive activity.

### **Compliance requirements**

With obligations imposed by:

- Local communities – in the form of compacts or other formal agreements
- Authorities – in the form of legislations and regulations
- Other bodies – in the form of Codes and industry Best practice initiatives.



### **Activity 11 - Identify objectives for interpretive activities**

Based on your selected themes, identify some objectives you would like to base your tour or activity around. In essence, these are the outcomes you wish to achieve.

| OBJECTIVES | KEY POINTS |
|------------|------------|
|            |            |
|            |            |
|            |            |
|            |            |



## Developing interpretive activities

When the themes and messages for an interpretive activity have been identified the next stage of development is to generate the specific activities which will be used to deliver the experience.

Activities are a common technique used in interpretive guiding and their selection and development needs to be carefully considered and addressed.

It is important to consider and utilise different interpretive activities which might be used when providing an interpretive eco-tourism guiding experience.

Whilst a summary of interpretive activities were identified in Section 1.3 of this manual, we will explore them in more detail in this section.



All the following are considered when identifying an interpretive activity to be presented in order to select the 'right' type of activity for a given situation, group or tour.

It is also important to understand:

- There are many different types of acceptable activities
- A good tour should feature a mix of different activities and approaches
- Different tours and themes lend themselves to different activities and approaches.

## Considerations when selecting interpretive activities

There is always a need to take the issues below into account when identifying the type of interpretive activity to be presented – the chosen activities must:

- Present required content – as advised by customers, contracts or communities
- Align with a stated theme – as indicated by the name of the tour
- Give an appropriate context – for the issue or tour being presented
- Meet advertised promises – made in promotional material for the tour
- Operate within applicable parameters – of time and budget
- Be safe to conduct – for participants, observers and others
- Integrate into other interpretive activities – and the general overall tour experience
- Accommodate development initiatives – of products and sites
- Match host communities' needs, wants and preferences
- Demonstrate compliance – with mandated and other self-imposed obligations and agreements
- Be environmentally sensitive – and sustainable





- Reflect identified customer needs, wants and preferences – to the best extent commensurate with other considerations
- Engage the tour group members – mentally or physically
- Optimise use of available resources
- Represent the most suitable and appropriate choice of activity – for the content being delivered
- Factor in the content and situation – in which they are to be implemented
- Be appropriate for individual audiences – for whom they are being used
- Be do-able – the Tour Guide must be able to do them.



## Types of interpretive activities

It is also important to identify some possible interactive activities in which content will be developed.

These may include:

- Guided site activities, including interactive and static displays
- Touring activities
- Commentaries
- Problem solving activities
- Concept testing activities
- Spotting and observation activities
- Any activity that facilitates engagement with the subject that is the focus of the activity.



Additional types of activities will be discussed in more detail.

## Conducting role plays

Role playing involves prescribed situations where tour group members or tour staff act out nominated roles and scenarios – in order to:

- Give or gain a sense of engagement and reality to various topics
- Experience a set of circumstances
- Practice responses to a hypothetical situation.

Commonly a de-briefing sessions with discussions and informed input from the Tour Guide follows these activities.

The role plays may be filmed for inclusion in a video or DVD provided to customers at the end of the tour.

### ***Using different voice techniques***

Different voice techniques will add interest to the tour and to a commentary.

They include:

- Speaking faster or slower
- Pausing or stopping and allowing a pause in the commentary
- Speaking louder or speaking more quietly.

Voice techniques can also include:

- Putting a Tour Guide 'in character' when discussing a certain person
- Using local names, terms and pronunciations
- Using local dialects and accents.



### ***Story telling***

Story-telling can be used to:

- Illustrate a point or make a point
- Contribute personal anecdotes
- Pass on a myth or legend
- Add interest and diversity.

### ***Games***

Games feature tour group member participation and as a result of their engagement they:

- Have fun
- Learn something
- Experience something new.

### ***Demonstrations***

Demonstrations are particularly useful techniques to use in interpretive activities and can be used in several ways.

They are effective because:

- They are active and illustrate the commentary
- They add variety, interest and entertainment
- They can demonstrate the competency of the Tour Guide and hence build credibility
- They can provide an opportunity to include the local community
- They enhance understanding and encourage engagement and questions.



They may:

- Be straight-forward demonstrations – where a skill is demonstrated to the group, and the group do not participate apart from observing
- Feature group action – where the tour group practices the skills being demonstrated
- Include descriptions and commentary as part of the demonstration
- Precede an activity where tour group members have to perform a skill.

The following information is taken from or based on material in the US National Park Service document [at <http://www.nps.gov/idp/interp/220/demolp.pdf>] (pp1 - 2):

*“There are three types of demonstrations:*

#### Simple demonstrations

*A ‘simple’ demonstration occurs when a process or activity is:*

- Demonstrated without explanation
- Demonstrated again, step-by-step, with explanation
- Finally placed in its larger context, significance, or meaning.

*‘Simple’ demonstrations provide entertainment, provocation, education, as well an opportunity to interpret the “big picture.”*

*They are most effectively used when visitors cannot or should not directly participate because of logistical, safety, or interpretive reasons i.e. the time necessary for direct participation precludes the overall objectives of the program.*

#### Participative demonstrations

*A ‘participative’ demonstration occurs when a process or activity:*

- Is demonstrated without explanation
- Is demonstrated again, step-by-step, with explanation
- Participants are then allowed to perform the process or activity
- Is finally placed in its larger context, significance, or meaning.

*‘Participative’ demonstrations provide entertainment, provocation, education, an opportunity to interpret the “big picture,” as well as teach the visitor a new skill. Therefore they involve the visitor to a greater degree than ‘simple’ demonstrations and ‘show and tell’ demonstrations’ and might engage and provoke the visitor to a larger degree.*

#### ‘Show and tell’ demonstrations

*A ‘show and tell’ demonstration is one where:*

- An object or objects are used to illustrate a concept
- They do not illustrate multi-step activities
- They can be used to illustrate single concepts or single steps in a process or activity.

*‘Show and tell’ demonstrations illustrate and make clear specific concepts or steps in a process or activity that words alone might not.”*

## Interpretive walking tours

'Planning interpretive walking tours for communities and related historic districts' by John Veverka (at [https://portal.uni-freiburg.de/interpreteurope/service/publications/recommended-publications/veverka\\_planning-interpretive-walkingtours.pdf](https://portal.uni-freiburg.de/interpreteurope/service/publications/recommended-publications/veverka_planning-interpretive-walkingtours.pdf)) states:

*"The basic interpretive planning process for developing walking tours considers the following six steps:*

1. *First consider the resource(s) to be interpreted.*
2. *The next step in the tour planning process is to consider just what you want the tour to accomplish – its OBJECTIVES. In this part of the planning process I consider the objectives for the total walking tour, and interpretive objectives for "each stop" on the walking tour.*
3. *The WHO part of our walking tour interpretive plan is where we consider just who the visitors are that we are trying to attract. This is important as it helps focus not only on what interpretive stops we will make on the tour, but the kinds of examples and stories we share with them. Each different market group might need some different "interpretive" considerations.*
4. *Media Selection. Once we have determined our resources to be interpreted (theme, route, etc.), our outcomes (objectives the tour is to accomplish), and the kinds of visitor groups that would be the most likely users of the waking tour, we need to think about the best media to be used for the walking tour itself.*
5. *Implementation and Operations. This part of the walking tour plan is where you list and consider just how the walking tour will go from "idea" to reality. I always like to make a checklist of things that have to be done or considered.*
6. *Does it Work? To me this is the most important part of the planning process, the evaluation of any draft materials to make sure that the objectives are accomplished. This can be easy or more complex depending you your time and budget. But always budget for the pre-testing of any walking tour."*



## Participant interaction

Participant interaction features activities where members of the tour group:

- Interact with each other
- Interact with members of a community
- Interact with the environment, situation or location.



A de-briefing and discussion session usually follows the activities so participants can compare experiences and share experiences.

## Sensory awareness exercises

These are exercises where people are able to

- Smell 'the roses' or the coffee, or other items relevant to the theme of the tour
- Taste food and beverages
- Feel textures, temperatures and weights.

Discussions, analysis and personal comparisons and thoughts may accompany the experience or participants may be encouraged to experience the exercise in solitude and reflect on their own orientations.

### ***Use of materials***

The use of materials is a commonly applied interpretive activity to enhance illustration and experiences.

Materials may feature the use of:

- Local products
- Visual aids
- Support materials
- Props.



### ***Use of technology***

Use of technology to assist with delivery is increasingly common in all tour types and with nearly all tour activities.

It may include:

- Audio-visual equipment
- Sound and lighting technologies
- Systems and equipment designed to optimise safety and or comfort.

## **Planning interpretive activities**

Planning consideration for activities include:

- Type of activity
- Staff who may deliver it – and training, experience or credentials required for delivery
- Resources available – within the organisation
- Resources required – usually presented with reference to the number of people to be involved
- Time required – for:
  - Pre-delivery preparation – obtaining resources, printing materials, practicing and rehearsing
  - Conduct and implementation of the activity in an actual tour situation
- Audience numbers:
  - Minimum required to make the activity viable and effective
  - Maximum – considering resources available, time, cost and potential for engagement





- Detailed description of activity including:
  - Sequencing of element
  - Timing
  - Suggested introduction
  - Actions to be undertaken by presenter
  - Central points to be raised
  - Matters which cannot be shared
  - Agreed involvement of local communities
  - Activities anticipated by tour group members
  - Central aspect of the activity.



## Using specialist personnel

In some cases those with responsibility for developing an interpretive activity may be able to involve a range of specialist personnel in the development phase.

In other cases, individuals are expected to 'do the best with what they've got' meaning they essentially have to develop the activity on their own using common sense, research findings and experience as the primary tools.

Where the time, funds and expertise is available, the specialist personnel who can be used may include:

### ***Subject matter experts***

- Provide information about identified topics
- Suggest themes and messages
- Facilitate personal research by identifying sources to investigate
- Supply existing materials which may be able to be used
- Give context for the theme
- Compare and contrast the message with other similar messages or themes
- Validate and fact-check information sourced by the Tour Guide as part of their research.



### ***Cultural advisers***

- Explaining heritage of people and communities
- Describing the emergence and evolution of cultures
- Detailing attitudes, behaviours and beliefs of the community
- Giving facts and detail relating to the identified activities
- Providing context in relation to the identified activities.

### ***Technical advisors and experts***

Who may provide suggestions and advice in relation to:

- A specific discipline of expertise
- Delivery options for commentaries and information
- Sound and lighting
- Risk management
- Direction and choreography
- Conduct and implementation of action-based interpretive options.



### ***Environmental educators***

Who may:

- Provide information on sustainable tourism activities
- Identify facts regarding the natural environments, habitats and eco-systems
- Contribute information to environment-related topics and themes
- Lead activities designed specifically focused on environmental issues
- Highlight the environmental challenges being faced by the local community
- Suggest activities to illustrate required themes.



### ***Interpretive consultants***

Who can assist with a wide-range of services such as:

- Training of staff in interpretive guiding and all aspects of interpretation
- Identifying and developing themes and activities to match identified need
- Developing interpretive programs, schedules and calendars
- Monitoring and evaluating delivery and implementation of interpretive guiding or activities
- Providing media liaison to promote initiatives
- Generating interpretive signage.





## Involve local community participation

This section discusses potential opportunities which might exist.

Many tours and interpretive activities include an opportunity for participation by the local community.

Opportunities for local community participation may relate to:

### ***Employing or engaging local people in nominated roles***

This includes opportunities to act as:

- Site Guides
- Supplementary guides
- Demonstrators
- Interpreters
- Facilitators
- Advisors.



### ***Capitalising on retail opportunities***

Which may exist or be created supplementary to the tours such as:

- Facilitating retail sales of items and artefacts by the indigenous community
- Using food and beverage services and facilities provided by the host community
- Encouraging tour group members to buy souvenirs and mementos
- Purchasing fuel and other tour supplies from community outlets
- Assisting with the development of suitable retail opportunities to capitalise on emerging potential.



### ***Increasing levels of public exposure for issues***

Which are:

- Impacting the community
- Significant to locals
- Regarded as being ignored by authorities
- Contrary to generally-accepted human rights.

### ***Chance to redress public misconceptions***

Which have been developed as a result of:

- Misinformation
- A deficit of information
- Lack of context.



## Activity 12 – Identify interpretive activities



Based on your selected themes and the objectives you wish to achieve when conducting an eco-tourism tour or series of activities, identify the various interpretive activities you would conduct to prospective customers.

| INTERPRETIVE ACTIVITY | KEY FEATURES OF ACTIVITY | PLANNING CONSIDERATIONS | USE OF SPECIALIST PERSONNEL | WAYS TO INVOLVE LOCAL COMMUNITY |
|-----------------------|--------------------------|-------------------------|-----------------------------|---------------------------------|
|                       |                          |                         |                             |                                 |
|                       |                          |                         |                             |                                 |
|                       |                          |                         |                             |                                 |
|                       |                          |                         |                             |                                 |
|                       |                          |                         |                             |                                 |

## 2.2 Acquire physical resources to support identified eco-tourism concepts, themes and focal points

### Introduction

When interpretive activities have been authorised for inclusion as part of a tour there will be a need to develop materials and resources to enable and support the delivery of the activity when on-tour.

This section presents considerations and examples in this regard and examples and differentiates between development and acquisition of resources.

### Importance of identifying required resources

Identifying resources required or available is necessary for the Tour Guide to:

- Allow cross-checking of what is required against what is available to support and enable it
- Become aware of the financial parameters for the tour and each activity and thus be able to operate the tour and the activities within budget
- Make sure all required resources have been loaded before the tour departs.



### Types of resources required to deliver interpretive activities

There are many types of resources that must be considered to successfully conduct interpretive activities.

These include the following:

#### ***Financial resources***

The Tour Guide must:

- Determine the budgets applicable to the tour and (where applicable) to each interpretive activity – there is a non-negotiable requirement all tours and activities must be accomplished or delivered within the allocated budgets
- Identify and obtain the cash they need to take with them when they depart – this money:
  - May be in local or other currency
  - Can be used to purchase items, equipment and services while on tour
  - Is used to pay entry fees
  - May be used to pay members of local or host communities for their participation in activities

- Identify and obtain non-cash payment requisites – such as:
  - Credit cards
  - Letters authorising purchase on behalf of the Tour Operator.

### ***Human resources***

These are the people who are available to provide assistance and services to the tour and the activities.

There will always be specification relating to:

- Staff numbers
- Hours available to each staff member
- Total staff wages for the tour including payments to external providers of services.



### ***Requirements for internal staff training***

It is essential staff receive effective training in the safe conduct of the activity prior to actual implementation on-tour.

### ***Materials***

These will include:

- Copies of all documents to be used elsewhere as part of the activity or tour
- Role play scenarios – to allow practice of required activities
- Supporting plans, policies and procedures for each activity
- Resource allocation sheets for each type of activity
- Lists of PPE required for individual activities
- All resources to enable implementation of the activity
- 'Tips for Guides' sheets
- Checklists for ensuring necessary safety checks are undertaken prior to tour activity implementation.



### ***Preparation of on-tour documents***

This can include, but not limited to:

- Safety tips
- Rules of the game
- Scripted commentary
- Participant checklists
- Maps
- Diagrams
- Photographs
- Guide books



- Binoculars
- Sight cards
- Activity sheets.

### ***Activity-related physical resources***

This may include:

- PPE
- Sports gear
- Props
- Costumes
- Equipment and items specific to each individual activity
- Special needs gear – to optimise engagement of special needs participants
- Natural resources – as appropriate.



### ***Presentation equipment***

This includes all equipment required to present, explain or conduct the activity which can include:

- PA systems and microphones
- Megaphones
- Overhead projectors
- Data projectors
- Slides and transparencies
- Laser pointers
- Personal electronic devices.





### ***Activity 13 – Identify resources for interpretive activities***



Based on your activities in Activity 13, identify the different types of resources required to complete the activities.

| INTERPRETIVE<br>ACTIVITY | FINANCIAL<br>RESOURCES | HUMAN<br>RESOURCES | MATERIALS | DOCUMENTATION | ACTIVITY<br>EQUIPMENT | PRESENTATION<br>EQUIPMENT |
|--------------------------|------------------------|--------------------|-----------|---------------|-----------------------|---------------------------|
|                          |                        |                    |           |               |                       |                           |
|                          |                        |                    |           |               |                       |                           |
|                          |                        |                    |           |               |                       |                           |
|                          |                        |                    |           |               |                       |                           |
|                          |                        |                    |           |               |                       |                           |

## Development or acquisition resources

Materials and physical resources may need to be 'developed' or 'acquired'.

### ***Development of resources***

This may include the following:

- Researching what is required
- Preparing materials
- Writing handouts, scripts, instructions and information
- Making a film or DVD
- Generating things 'from scratch'
- Modifying existing resources.



### ***Acquiring resources***

This can include:

- Buying resources from a third party
- Borrowing resources from someone or another business
- Sharing the cost of purchase between other Tour Operators
- Asking others to donate items
- Hiring items
- Using resources which already exist within the business
- Being given resources, items or materials from local communities or government agencies.





## Activity 14 – Identify advantages and disadvantages of resource acquisition methods

You are required to identify the advantages and disadvantages of using different resource acquisition methods.

Provide at least two examples of resources you would acquire for your eco-tourism tour or activities.



### DEVELOPMENT OF RESOURCES

| ADVANTAGES | DISADVANTAGES | EXAMPLES OF RESOURCE ACQUIRED USING THIS METHOD |
|------------|---------------|-------------------------------------------------|
|            |               | 1.                                              |
|            |               | 2.                                              |
|            |               | 3.                                              |
|            |               | 4.                                              |

### ACQUIRING RESOURCES

| ADVANTAGES | DISADVANTAGES | EXAMPLES OF RESOURCE ACQUIRED USING THIS METHOD |
|------------|---------------|-------------------------------------------------|
|            |               | 1.                                              |
|            |               | 2.                                              |
|            |               | 3.                                              |
|            |               | 4.                                              |

## Obtaining necessary permits

It is essential that the permissions and authorisations for the tour and for each activity are obtained.

This may require:

- Sighting written evidence management has authorised the tour and the activities to be implemented as described in the plans according to the resources identified– or obtaining face-to-face authorisation from management
- Verifying permits have been obtained allowing entry to certain areas
- Making sure there is respect for indigenous people by checking to see host communities have agreed to:
  - Allow tours onto their lands and into their communities
  - Conduct certain activities
  - Provide nominated goods or services to the tour
- Confirming the requirements of all applicable 'other requirements' have been met – these considerations may relate to:
  - Compliance with agreed Codes of Conduct with host communities
  - Alignment with Codes of Practice developed by industry associations to which the Tour Operator belongs
  - Requirements imposed by the QA scheme used by the Operator.



### ***Activity 15 – Identify permits to conduct activities***

You are required to identify the different permits required to undertake your proposed eco-tourism tours or activities

| TYPE OF PERMIT | CONDITIONS OF PERMIT<br>(What it entitles you to do) | HOW TO ACQUIRE PERMIT |
|----------------|------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------|
|                |                                                      |                       |
|                |                                                      |                       |
|                |                                                      |                       |

## 2.3 Generate scripted commentaries to support identified eco-tourism concepts, themes and focal points

### Introduction

One of the main features of providing 'interpretive content' is to have commentary to support activities.

All tour commentaries should be well thought out, accurate, entertaining and containing all essential information to help customers understand and enjoy the tour and associated activities.

This section will focus on the development of commentaries.

### Benefits of commentary scripts

Even though interpretive guiding is far, far more than the provision of basic information, scripted commentaries nonetheless remain a mainstay of interpretive activities in that:

- They allow the quick and efficient communication of information and facts
- They can be used to reinforce and remind tour group members of detail and data pertinent to an activity
- They can be pre-planned and practiced
- They are expected – tour group members expect a commentary
- They are inexpensive.



### Considerations when preparing commentary scripts

The basic development process for a scripted commentary can be seen as comprising the following tasks:

#### ***Identify the commentary information that needs to be conveyed***

As determined by:

- Special requests and contracted obligations
- The route
- The itinerary
- Advertised inclusions and promises made.

#### ***Research the selected commentary information that needs to be conveyed***

Using a range of research strategies to discover:

- Qualitative information
- Quantitative information.

### ***Obtain copies of sample tour commentary scripts***

Which have been prepared by others and which have been used on tours to get an idea of things such as?

- Layout
- Phrasing and terminology
- Extent of coverage and detail of topics
- How the commentary commences and concludes.

### ***Talk to other Tour Guides***

Who have developed scripts for tour commentaries to get their personal advice and tips on:

- How to go about the task
- The sequence in which they create the draft
- Pitfalls to avoid.



### ***Classify commentary information***

That has been gathered:

- According to identified customer need
- For ease of future use.

### ***Develop themes for the commentary information***

That needs to be conveyed.

### ***Prepare draft scripts for commentary information that needs to be conveyed***

- Prepare draft script
- Trial the draft scripts
- Revise draft scripts as required.

### ***Learn supporting information***

As it related to the theme or tour

### ***Implement the scripted commentary***

Implement and update on the basis of:

- Feedback
- Lessons learned.



## Principles for writing commentary scripts

It is important to adhere to the principles and actions described below when creating a draft script for a tour commentary:

### ***Realising the creation of a good scripted commentary for a tour takes time***

It can take weeks to generate a comprehensive script.

The longer the duration of the tour and the more topics which have to be covered, the longer the time required

Certainly, new tour scripts cannot be written on-the-day.

### ***Ensuring currency and accuracy of content***

This must include:

- A total ban on fabrication of facts
- Separation of opinion from facts
- Fact-checking and verification.



### ***Ensuring comprehensive and relevant information***

This relates to:

- Checking to verify all required topics and content have been addressed
- Providing contextual information
- Eliminating irrelevant or extraneous information – there is never enough time to address everything in a commentary.

### ***Including necessary safety and security information***

As relevant to:

- The time of day
- Route conditions
- Anticipated weather
- Activities and inclusions while on-tour.

### ***Ordering the information in logical sequence***

It is important to have a formal structure.

This means including for each topic, destination or for the general script:

- An introduction – to the activity, site, topic or whatever is being talked about
- A body – the main content
- A conclusion – summarising what has been presented
- Matching information to tour locations, destinations, attractions, activities and inclusions.



### ***Preparing sufficient information***

This means covering appropriate depth and breadth of information, ensuring there is sufficient time when on-tour to deliver this information.

This can be applied in terms of (for example) being able to stop at a location when talking, or being able to deliver the information on the tour vehicle before the destination or attraction has been reached.

### ***Choosing and using appropriate language***

Which relates to:

- Writing the commentary in a language which can be understood by the tour party – or arranging for an interpreter and factoring in to the commentary the delay to timing this will introduce
- Matching words, phrases and terminology to the identified needs of customers
- Ensuring the commentary explains and translates the characteristics, significance and features of the tour
- Explaining unfamiliar terms, abbreviations and acronyms
- Checking grammar – used for the script and sentences used
- Attention must also be paid to ensuring correct pronunciation of words, names of people, historical figures, place names, botanical names
- Ensuring that language used does not give offence – including unintended offence in relation to:
  - Gender
  - Culture
  - Race
  - Age
  - Personal characteristics.



### ***Matching the length of the script***

To:

- The duration of various activities
- Travel times
- Length of the tour.



### ***Providing an appropriate mix***

Of:

- Quantitative information – these are the facts, figures and statistics
- Qualitative information – which is descriptive information other than statistical information.

### ***Writing the script from the tour group members' perspective***

For example if the Tour Guide is at the front of a bus or tractor train and facing backwards towards the visitors, they must identify landmarks from **their** viewpoint. For example, do not say "On my right is a fine example of ...", instead say 'On your left'.

### ***Involving others in the writing of the script***

Involving others can be useful as a means of:

- Contributing to and generating ideas
- Providing information, facts and figures
- Functioning as a sounding board for ideas
- Practicing the commentary on.

### ***Identify the commentary for the tour and each interpretive activity***

These:

- Are generally standard 'scripted commentaries' – which contain required detail for every tour and activity
- May need to be individually developed for custom tours
- Often require the addition of supplementary commentary in order to:
  - Cater for special requests and seasonal factors
  - Accommodate unexpected interruptions or the need to alter planned activities and inclusions
  - Suit the particular requirements of custom tours.



## ***Activity 16 - Prepare commentaries***

You are required to prepare commentaries for the events or activities you are to conduct as part of your tour.





## 2.4 Trial developed eco-tourism activities for identified concepts, themes and focal points

### Introduction

Once all the elements of an eco-tourism activity have been identified, it is now time to plan, implement, monitor and review the interpretive activity.

This section will look at what needs to be planned and implemented as part of a 'trial run' of an interpretive activity.

In essence it is the same as a 'live' activity and should be treated with the same amount of seriousness and professionalism.

It is important to note that not all aspects of conducting an interpretive tour will be explained in this section.

The focus will primarily on conducting specific activities and the associated content.

Some tour administrative tasks may be briefly explained, but not all will be covered.



### Trial eco-tourism activities

These may include:

- Undertake planning of eco-tourism activities
- Conducting the eco-tourism activities as planned, including all planned activities and all scripted commentaries
- Including participants and observers for the trial
- Ensuring the trial reflects expected actual tour conditions for the activity, to the greatest extent possible
- Recording the trial for later analysis or review.

### Undertake planning of eco-tourism activities

Before implementing a planned interpretive activity there is a need for the Tour Guide to plan accordingly.

These needs will vary between the different types of activities which are to be presented so with this in mind consideration of planning needs may embrace:

#### ***Consideration of the timing***

To ensure:

- The activity is going to be delivered in accordance with the itinerary
- Confirmation of the duration of the activity to be presented – which means determining the finish time for the activity



- Other activities and inclusions for the tour can be delivered as advertised
- Variations to planned timing needs to be made to respond to issues arising on tour
- Local communities are ready to receive the tour group or begin their participation in the interpretive activity.

### ***Consideration of the weather***

To:

- Make sure it is safe to conduct the activity given the weather conditions which exist at the time
- Verify appropriate resources are available to suit the weather conditions which apply at the time
- Decide if an alternative interpretive activity needs to be presented instead of the original, planned activity
- Determine if the interpretive activity needs to be cancelled due to adverse weather conditions.



### ***Consideration of the physical resources***

To verify:

- Required resources are available to allow the planned interpretive activity to be delivered
- Sufficient resources are available and ready to use
- The available resources are safe to use
- Resources advertised as being available are ready to be used or distributed to tour group members
- The security of resources to be used and those which are to be left on the tour vehicle
- Equipment and items provided by third party providers are safe and suitable for the activity to be conducted
- Consideration of the personnel – to ensure:
  - All tour staff understand their role and responsibilities in relation to the interpretive activity
  - Staff are ready to start the activity
  - The Tour Guide who will conduct or present the activity is ready to start
  - Members of the local community are ready to play their part
- Consideration of the tour group members – to:
  - Determine their readiness to engage with the interpretive activity
  - Calculate when and where relevant information about the activity will be communicated with them
  - Determine their physical, mental or attitudinal capacity or potential to safely engage with the activity



- Identify any special requests or requirements which they have made regarding the activity or their engagement with it
- Consideration of the physical environment – to:
  - Verify the location in which the interpretive activity is to be conducted
  - Check the safety and suitability of the location
  - Confirm the physical environment reflects the physical environment used when the risk management or planning for the activity was undertaken
  - Demonstrate respect for indigenous people and local communities
  - Take action to minimise the impact of the interpretive activity on the physical environment.

## Prepare interpretive activity requirements

The first physical action involved in making on-tour preparations for implementation of an interpretive activity in the field is the preparation of on-tour resources to support the activity.

In Section 2.2 of this manual, the different types of resources have been identified.

It is important set up the activity in accordance with plans for it, emphasises the need for respect for local customs and people, indicates the requirement to prepare tour group members for the activity, and mentions possible need to keep preparations secret from tour group members.

The Tour Guide must make sure setting up an interpretive activity is in accordance with the plans for it.

This is generally a non-negotiable requirement but Tour Guides are always expected to use their personal judgement, common sense and experience to make adjustments in order to optimise safety, maximise engagement with customers, ensure compliance with legislation and applicable Codes of Conduct or Practice and local agreements, and make sure budgets are not exceeded.

Plans prepared for the interpretive activity should be adhered to for the following reasons:

- Following the plans decreases the time required for set up – because functional directions and an effective list of preparatory activities in the sequential order will be provided
- They have been subjected to standard risk assessment protocols of risk identification, risk evaluation and risk control – and are therefore safe to conduct only ‘as planned’
- They will comply with budget constraints imposed by the Tour Operator – regarding labour, physical resources of other expenditure items
- The plans may have been developed in consultation with certain people who have insisted or required they be implemented ‘as stated’
- Implementation according to the plan ensures compliance with all safety requirements – and Duty of Care obligations
- They will have been created to allow ‘the right amount’ of time for each activity – based on its individual type on the basis of trialling, experience and feedback received
- Implementation of an interpretive activity according to the plan will optimise the outcomes for the activity – and therefore increase satisfaction levels for tour group members, thereby increasing the potential for return or referral business.

Setting up an interpretive activity can involve the following generic actions:

- Obtaining resources – from:
  - Tour vehicles
  - Third party providers
- Inspecting the condition of equipment and other items – to:
  - Make sure they are safe
  - Clean or repair items as necessary
- Obtaining handout materials, equipment and other physical resources – for:
  - Distribution to tour group members
  - Use within the activity
- Checking the activity area – to:
  - Confirm safety issues
  - Determine appropriate availability of locations
- Holding a briefing – with:
  - Other Tour Guides and staff from the business
  - Others from outside the business who will be participating in the activity or delivering some aspect of the activity.



### ***Activity 17 – Identify interpretive activity planning steps***

You are asked to outline the necessary planning you would need to undertake if you were to conduct your proposed eco-tourism tour or activity.

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## Respect local communities

At all times the Tour Guide must ensure there is respect shown for local communities.

Practical aspects of this requirement may include:

- Meeting with local communities to develop Codes of Practice and other working agreements – in relation to tours and the conduct of interpretive activities
- Developing Codes of Conduct – for tour group members who visit host communities
- Notifying communities in advance – of dates and times of expected tours
- Maintaining regular contact with local communities – to obtain their feedback in relation to their experiences with tours so necessary adjustments to Codes and agreements can be made
- Providing economic opportunity for host communities – in terms of payment for work on tour-related jobs (guides, entertainers, demonstrators) the provision of retail opportunities (to sell goods and services to the tour group members) or the provision of food and beverages
- Advising the communities before the tour – so they receive a reminder of the tour and receive updated information about numbers, special requests and other relevant matters
- Notifying tour group members of acceptable and unacceptable conduct
- Asking permission to enter lands or communities – every time a tour or activity is conducted on their land or in their community
- Observing the necessary cultural constraints – as required by different communities and cultures
- Maintaining secrecy of items and information – as requested by the host community
- Involving the host community in decision making which impacts them – so decisions and activities are never imposed on them against their will
- Parking only in designated areas – as prescribed by the communities
- Staying on designated walking tracks and agreed pedestrian routes – as opposed to walking 'anywhere and everywhere'
- Prohibiting taking of photographs – of certain areas or of people
- Banning use of limited local resources – such as water
- Identifying and banning carriage of nominated items onto community property – this ban may be on fast food, newspapers, bottles, disposable nappies
- Cleaning up after using facilities – or a ban on using facilities
- Modifying tours and interpretive activities – on the basis of feedback received from the local communities.







## **Activity 18 - Identify opportunities for local community involvement**

You are asked to outline how you can provide positive opportunities for local community involvement in your region if you were to undertake if you were to conduct your proposed eco-tourism tour or activity.




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### **Ensure safety issues are addressed**

A vital part of the preparation for an on-tour activity is the need to ensure all safety issues have been addressed.

#### **Safety and security**

All Tour Guides need to ensure they discharge the legal 'Duty of Care' imposed on them or the Tour Operator for every tour and every interpretive activity.

All businesses and employees have a common law Duty of Care to:

- Create and maintain a workplace or touring environment that does not pose a risk to people including staff, members of the public, customers
- Take action to avoid causing foreseeable harm to people or their belongings while they are on tour or participating in an interpretive activity.

For a Tour Guide this means they need to read the plans which have been prepared to:

- Become familiar with the risk management plans developed for the tour and for each activity
- Gain familiarity with and a thorough understanding of all applicable risk control measures which are required to be implemented
- Ensure all resources necessary to support and implement the required risk controls are provided
- Check the equipment or tour arrangements provide sufficient security.

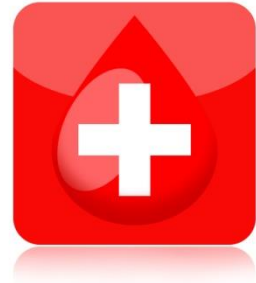


## ***Emergency equipment***

Safety-related checks need to ensure:

- Emergency equipment identified as part of the risk management process for the activity is available as identified
- Emergency Management Plans are available
- Presence of nominated first-aid kits
- Availability of or access to necessary retrieval, rescue and recovery equipment
- Presence of communication equipment to raise alarm or summon additional assistance.

In some cases the presence of designated fire-fighting equipment and resources may be seen as a necessary element of emergency equipment.



## ***Safety equipment***

Safety equipment is often known as PPE (personal protective equipment and clothing).

The intention of PPE is to prevent harm or injury.

It is the responsibility of the Tour Operator to:

- Provide appropriate PPE for the group
- Check all PPE to be used prior to use
- Ensure all participants use PPE as required.

PPE is provided for all tour group members and staff – in order to:

- Enable them to participate in scheduled activities, sports, events, games and other inclusions.

For example when conducting white water rafting or kayaking there would be a need to provide high-visibility life jackets or PFD, safety helmets, knee and elbow pads, whistles, rescue ropes, rescue rope throw bags, neoprene booties, white water knives, padded gloves.

- Protect them from naturally occurring harm when on-tour.

Checks must ensure:

- Equipment is available in the sizes listed in the EMP
- Items are available in the numbers specified
- Gear is operating as required
- Items are safe to use.







## Activity 19 - Identify safety equipment

You are asked to outline the safety equipment you would need if you were to undertake if you were to conduct your proposed eco-tourism tour or activity.

For each piece of equipment identify the checks you would make to ensure they are ready.

| PIECE OF SAFETY EQUIPMENT | PURPOSE OF PIECE OF SAFETY EQUIPMENT | CHECK CONDUCTED TO ENSURE READY FOR SERVICE |
|---------------------------|--------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------|
|                           |                                      |                                             |
|                           |                                      |                                             |
|                           |                                      |                                             |
|                           |                                      |                                             |
|                           |                                      |                                             |
|                           |                                      |                                             |



## Conduct briefings with staff

While the nature of each briefing session prior to an interpretive activity will be unique, based as it will be on the delivery of a particular activity, there are nonetheless several common issues which will require coverage.

These include:

- Roll call – this is done to:
  - Ensure all required staff are present as required
  - Cross-check staff present against expected names and numbers
  - Confirm role allocation for the activity
  - Allow Tour Guide to meet and appraise all workers
- Provision of an overview of the activity – this involves:
  - Making sure everyone has a copy of the plan
  - A read-through of the goals and objectives for the activity
  - Description of relevant matters for the activity – which can include:
    - Themes and messages
    - Special requests
    - Presence of VIPs on the tour
    - Changes to be factored in – due to, for example, need to shorten or extend the activity
- Confirmation the activity should proceed – according to risk management protocols
- Discussion of duration for the activity – which may relate to:
  - Confirmation of a scheduled starting time
  - Confirmation of a scheduled finishing
  - Verification with others that timing is appropriate
  - Notification of revisions to scheduled starting and finishing times
- Development or confirmation of arrangements to address issues arising – these may be regarding matters to do with:
  - Modifications to the standard activity imposed as a result of changes to the location where the activity is to be conducted
  - Maintenance of safety and security where a legitimate need to change standard actions has emerged
  - Amendments deemed appropriate to alter the duration of the activity in order to maintain the overall itinerary for the tour
  - Required revisions to accommodate special requests



- Changes brought about by the need to modify proceedings for certain budgetary reasons
- Alterations deemed prudent based on feedback obtained from the tour group while on-tour – in order to better meet their expectations and optimise their level of satisfaction
- Allocation of staff to required positions – this will generally be a matter of:
  - Confirming the arrangements described in the plans and tested during the role trialling for the activity
  - Adjusting staff allocation based on special needs of individual tour group members which have materialised on-tour or been advised at the commencement of the tour
  - Checking staff allocated to certain positions can comprehensively recite their role while in those positions
  - Confirming with relevant personnel there are sufficient staff in position at each location to enable required activities to be undertaken as expected
  - Ensuring, where required by legislation or internal operational protocols, staff used at certain locations:
    - Hold necessary credentials or certification
    - Have required experience
- Verification of the presence of physical resources – as appropriate to the type of activity, including:
  - Handouts and paper-based materials for distribution
  - Food and beverages
  - Basis requisites – such as note pads, pens, sun hats, umbrellas
  - Technology and devices for self-tours
  - Sports equipment
  - Emergency equipment
  - Safety clothing and equipment, where necessary
- Conduct of communication checks – to verify full operational status of equipment and devices to be used to:
  - Communicate between each other
  - Make contact with other third party providers.



## Introducing the interpretive activity

Once all the planning has taken place, the interpretive tour or activity will commence.

The first step in introducing an interpretive activity to tour group members is to alert them to the tour or activity.

It is important to make participants aware of all up-coming interpretive activities in order to:

- Meet expectations – they expect to be made aware of what is happening
- Generate excitement and a sense of anticipation – which enhances enjoyment of the tour
- Get people talking – about the imminent event
- Keep people informed – to let them know how the tour is progressing in terms of the itinerary they have been given
- Allow individuals to prepare – on a personal basis, which may be:
  - Getting ready
  - Making a 'comfort stop'
  - Checking their camera
  - Having something to eat and drink
  - Changing clothes and footwear
- Give them an opportunity to:
  - Ask questions
  - Lodge special requests
  - Read handout material.



## Key points of interpretive activity to explain

There are a number of key points that must be introduced to all tour group members regarding up-coming activities including:

- Making verbal group-based announcements – which may be made:
  - Along the route of a walking tour
  - At rest or meals stops or breaks
  - On the tour vehicle
  - At end-of-day sessions for multiple day tours
  - At briefing sessions at the start of each day for multiple day tours.

- Provide a welcome – which must:
  - Identify the physical location of the activity
  - Identify the activity
  - Explain what to expect
  - Identifying about timing – start and finish times
  - Notifying of any necessary changes which have to be made – together with explanation of reason
  - Demonstrate enthusiasm for what is about to be presented
  - Provide relevant background information to the activity
  - Give a suitable context for the activity
  - Link this activity to any previous activities which have similarity relevance
- Including them on the itinerary, and:
  - Making sure everyone receives a copy of the itinerary when they are issued with their ticket
  - Posting a copy of the itinerary in the camp or in the tour vehicle
- Presentation of site-specific Code of Conduct – with which all tour group members are expected to comply highlighting, describing and illustrating:
  - Acceptable and unacceptable behaviour
  - Acceptable and unacceptable language
  - Rationale for same
  - Consequences of failing to comply
- Notifying tour members of basic operational parameters – in terms of:
  - Start and finish times
  - Safety issues
  - Physical and geographical parameters relating to the activity
  - 'Do's' and 'Don'ts' for the activity
- Introducing other staff who will assist the Tour Guide – in terms of:
  - Providing advice to tour group members
  - Demonstrating requirements to participants
  - Supervising and controlling the overall activity or particular aspects of it
  - Specialist roles and responsibilities



- Distributing materials, resources or equipment – which tour group members might:
  - Read to gain background knowledge about the activity
  - Use to engage in a practical way with the activity
  - Provide instructions, directions, tips, advice and suggestions to optimise engagement with and enjoyment from the activity

These may include:

- Notes and handouts
  - Information sheets and brochures
  - Maps
  - Samples
  - Snacks
  - Name tags
- Demonstrating use of items required in relation to the activity – this may involve showing how to:
    - Wear or use safety clothing and protective items
    - Use tools or sporting equipment
    - Achieve whatever may be the objective for the activity
- Assessing individual capacity for individual tour group members to participate in the activity – in terms of their:
    - Age
    - Height and weight
    - Physical fitness
    - Previous experience
    - Stated reluctance to participate
- Encouraging tour group members to engage with the activity – by:
    - Motivating people to attend or watch
    - Motivating them through anecdotes and personal enthusiasm
    - Identifying the potential benefits and learning they may take from the activity
    - Offering ongoing help and support for them while they participate
    - Setting challenges
    - Stressing the unique nature of the activity or experience
- Responding as appropriate – to:
    - Questions
    - Concerns
    - Fears
    - Issues arising



- Speaking to people on an individual basis – to:
  - Ensure all group members are aware of up-coming activities
  - Show interest in individuals
  - Optimise likelihood of responding positively to all concerns raised.

## Using recorded introductions

Some tours and activities feature the use of recorded ‘introductions’.

These:

- Are standard video or audio welcomes shown at the start of nominated activities – to all tour group members
- May incorporate other aspects of the activity also – such as:
  - Explanations of activities
  - Demonstrations of practice
  - Identified risk associated with the activity
  - Safety issues
- Will require tour group members to be assembled in some form – so they can gain optimum information from them, either:
  - On the tour vehicle
  - In a room
- Should be supplemented by a face-to-face ‘live’ session – which:
  - Allows additional information to be provided
  - Enables questions to be answered.



## Explaining interpretive activities

After tour group members have been formally introduced to the interpretive activity, the activity must be explained to them.

Practicalities in relation to explaining an interpretive activity are:

- In many cases the presentation of this section is undertaken at the same time as ‘demonstrations’ for the activity
- In some cases the ‘introduction’, as described above, also includes an explanation of the activity – as well as demonstration of necessary pre-requisites
- Care must be taken to ensure correct positioning of tour group members and presentation staff – so:
  - Everyone can hear what is said
  - All can see what is done





- Amplification of explanations may be acceptable or necessary – where this:
  - Does not negatively impact local amenity
  - Does not intrude on the enjoyment of others
- Presentation must reflect the plans for the activity – in terms of:
  - What is said
  - Sequence of information
  - Individual roles and responsibilities of staff conducting the explanation
  - Training undertaken for this part of the activity
- The explanation must be in accordance with previous information provided about the activity – as presented, for example:
  - In advertisements and promotions for the tour or activity
  - In contracts for the tour
  - On itineraries
  - At previous advisory sessions
  - During earlier discussions
- Linkages should be made to previous activities – with reference to:
  - Experiences
  - Lessons learned
  - New thoughts or perspectives gained
- Explanations must always include training for the activity – with reference to:
  - Demonstrations – see later in this section
  - Practice
  - Tips and advice for optimising competency
  - Rules of the game
  - Objectives of the activity
- Need to pay attention to the time spent on explanations – which means:
  - There needs to be ‘sufficient’ explanation
  - The explanation must never dominate or steal time from the actual activity
  - Explanations must never be padded out
- There can be a need for repetition of explanations – with attention paid to perhaps:
  - Repeating what has been said
  - Paraphrasing – saying the same thing but using different words
- Checking for understanding – through a combination of activities as described later in this section



- Willingness to use other tour group members to help with explanations – where:
  - This is appropriate
  - More experienced persons appear ready to assist less experienced ones
- Highlighting risks associated with the activity – in terms of:
  - Type and timing
  - Location
  - Management and control
  - Potential impact
- Action to take in the event of certain eventualities – such as:
  - Difficulty
  - Danger
  - Incident and accident
  - Changed circumstances or weather
  - Becoming lost or separated from group.



## Communication techniques

In relation to delivering a commentary the following are useful supplementary communication techniques which can assist in delivering a more effective and memorable commentary:

- Repeat parts of the commentary – to give those who did not hear the opportunity to listen to what was said, or hear all the content
- Be prepared to paraphrase what has already been said – when there is a lack of understanding. This means repeating what was originally said but using different terms to say the same thing
- Speak at a different pace – to match the requirements of the participants or their stated needs
- Use plenty of pointing and hand gestures – to indicate what is being commented on and to provide guidance and direction about where things are and where people need to look in order to see what is being talked about
- Interact with the group – ask them questions; seek their feedback, talk about their feelings and what they are experiencing
- Be constantly alert to barriers to communications – and proactively seek to avoid or address them
- Common barriers are noise and line-of-sight obstacles.
- Check for understanding of what has been said
- Use extra staff – to assist with delivering commentary to a bigger than normal group
- Address emotional barriers such as distress, pain, intra-group conflict, conflicting personalities before continuing with commentary.



## Demonstrate activity pre-requisites

Following the explanation the interpretive activity may require certain pre-requisites to be demonstrated to tour group participants.

Demonstrating necessary pre-requisites may involve:

- Implementing approved plans for demonstration of the interpretive activity – according to:
  - The individual activity
  - Site constraints
  - Training, role plays and drills in this regard
- Distributing equipment – such as:
  - Handing out items
  - Naming the items
  - Describing their use
- Integrating explanations with demonstrations – so:
  - Understanding is optimised
  - There is a seamless delivery of information
  - Safety is a constant thread
- Using the tour team to conduct a simulated activity – to:
  - Show how to undertake the activity
  - Demonstrate tips and techniques
  - Highlight certain aspects of the activity such as:
    - Teamwork
    - Speed
    - Skill levels
    - Observation of the environment
    - Interpretation of data, evidence or material
    - Application of the rules
    - Alignment with outcomes



- Focusing on the standard presentation technique for demonstrations – which includes:
  - Demonstrating at normal speed what needs to be done with no explanation whatsoever
  - Then demonstrating slowly and step-by-step with explanations at each stage – perhaps asking participants what the next step is or why the next stage needs to occur
  - Asking tour group members to join in – and practice or demonstrate the activity at the same time as the Tour Guide
  - Providing time for individual practice – with supervision and, where necessary, assistance in order to generate some level of competency
  - Building on known previous knowledge
- Walking the activity ground – which means:
  - Physically walking around the activity site
  - Pointing to dangers and risks – and highlighting the actions or controls which are inherent to prevent accident or injury
  - Providing specific techniques which may be useful at different points of the activity
  - Highlighting location of safety equipment, rescue gear or emergency equipment
  - Indicating where Safety Officers will be positioned – and how tour group members should gain their attention
- Distributing activity-related items if required – together with:
  - Providing Instructions or directions
  - Explaining rules for games or activities
  - Linking use of items to intended outcomes
- Distributing safety equipment, if required – including:
  - Naming items – and important parts of same
  - Explaining and demonstrating use of same
  - Indicating why and when items are required
  - Highlighting location of items during the activity
- Showing how to use equipment – which should cover:
  - Demonstrating how to use games equipment
  - Illustrating use of activity-specific items
  - Linking safety to use of equipment and items



- Showing use of PPE – in terms of:
  - Demonstrating how to wear necessary safety clothing
  - Helping tour group participants correctly wear protective clothing
  - Demonstrating how to use personal safety items
  - Helping individuals achieve basic competence in use of personal safety items
- Showing how to use emergency equipment – with attention paid to:
  - Indication of triggers for implementing use of same
  - Explanation and illustration of role of customers and roles of tour staff in the event of an emergency
  - Identification of available items
  - Specification of location of emergency equipment
- Employing the services of ‘sufficient’ personnel – to:
  - Speed up the process
  - Facilitate the process of demonstration
  - Give enough options for all customers to look at and learn from
- Allocating sufficient time for the demonstrations – such that:
  - Safety is optimised
  - The activity is never unnecessarily delayed
  - Understanding of requirements is confirmed
  - Proportionality is maintained – that is:
    - It is more important safety is covered where identified risks exist than is the case where no genuine risks have been identified
    - Serious things deserve serious treatment.



## Confirm customer understanding of upcoming activity

A vital part of the explanation and demonstration phase is the need to ensure tour group members understanding of requirements.

There are several important reasons to ensure tour group members understand explanations and demonstrations relating to an up-coming interpretive activity:

- It helps demonstrate discharge of the common law Duty of Care – and thus helps protect staff and the business against legal action
- It helps optimise safety for everyone – which must always be the primary consideration regardless of all other factors
- It generates increased involvement and engagement with the activity – and so optimises the twin potentials for increased levels of customer satisfaction and sense of achievement
- It allows an opportunity for people to ask questions – and further clarify issues or ambiguities



- It provides another chance for users to gain familiarity with what is required – and increase their personal level of competence
- It increases the likelihood tour group members will learn from the experience – or achieve one or more of the identified objectives for the activity
- It underlines the potential for accident and injury – and thereby focuses the mind and attention on the activity.

### ***Strategies for confirming understanding***

It is best to use a combination of techniques to confirm tour group member understanding of an activity.

Options include:

- Asking questions – to check knowledge or understanding
- Administering a basic ‘test’ – which may be:
  - A verbal informal assessment
  - A written test – usually brief in nature such as ‘True’ or ‘False’, or ‘Select the correct response’
  - A practical test – which can cover:
    - Use of safety or emergency equipment
    - Implementation of standard procedures
- Checking of individual customers – in terms of:
  - Physically checking the items of equipment each person is going to use
  - Physically checking the fit and wearing of safety clothing
  - Asking people to move within their safety clothing
  - Posing individual tests for people
  - Eligibility criteria
- Encouraging customers to ask questions – by:
  - Asking for questions
  - Responding politely and positively to them
  - Thanking those who ask them
- Providing additional guidance and explanation – as deemed necessary based on:
  - The nature of the question asked
  - The degree of misunderstanding which appears to be present
- Monitoring people actively to judge levels of understanding – by:
  - Reading their body language
  - Interpreting their facial expressions
  - Listening to what they say and how they say it.



## Provide interpretive commentary

Conduct of interpretive activities will traditionally require the provision of commentary and the use of a range of interpretive presentation techniques.

All tours will require some form of commentary.

Not all interpretive activities will.

Commentary may be described as:

- Scripted
- Unscripted.

### ***Scripted commentary***

A scripted commentary is a prepared talk about identified topics of interest to a group of tour group members.

The scripted commentary may be prepared by the Tour Operator and provided for use by the Tour Guide, or there may be a need for every Tour Guide to develop their own scripted commentary for each group they lead and for every interpretive activity they conduct.

A scripted commentary should be thought of as a guide about what needs to be said rather than a complete list of everything that needs to be said during an activity.



There will always be a need to provide some unscripted commentary to supplement whatever scripted commentary is prepared.

### ***Unscripted commentary***

Unscripted commentary refers to the situation where information is provided to the tour group throughout the activity but reference is not made to a script when doing so.

In many cases, experienced Tour Guides will memorise the scripted commentary for scheduled tours and interpretive activities.

### ***Advice on delivering scripted commentary***

Basic communication strategies which should be used to deliver commentaries may include:

- Ensuring visibility to all tour group members – it is preferable if all people participating in the activity can also read and see the lips of the Tour Guide when they are speaking but at a minimum they should at least be able to see the person speaking to some extent
- Facing the group – to the greatest extent possible
- Speaking loudly enough for everyone to hear – or using technology to help project the voice
- Remaining enthusiastic and appropriate to the nature and content of the activity – and appropriate to the nature of the tour group members. Some groups or topics require a sombre approach and others a lively and engaging demeanour
- Beginning the verbal commentary sufficiently in advance of a scheduled event – so participants have time to focus on whatever is the focus of the commentary



- Alternatively a decision may be taken to arrive at a location, and then deliver all the commentary at this point. Timing constraints will often dictate which option needs to be used, as will the response of the tour group
- Focusing attention on entire group – the commentary must be directed at, and embrace, all the tour group members.

Never fall for the common traps of:

- Talking only to those who are closest
- Directing commentary at those in the immediate line-of-sight
- Commentating only to one or two 'special' group members
- Focussing on a certain person, age group, nationality or gender
- Communicating at level that will be understood by the audience considering their age, education, language, culture and special needs – this frequently means:
  - Keeping things simple
  - Using hand gestures to accompany verbal communication
  - Using appropriate words, terms and phrases
  - Highlighting points identified as being of interest to the group
- Seeking feedback from the group throughout the commentary:
  - Can they hear or see?
  - Anything else they want to know?
  - Do they want a break?
- Encouraging questions – and responding to them in a way which demonstrates questions really are encouraged and appreciated
- Making the commentary a 'unique' event – avoid allowing commentaries to:
  - Become boring and lifeless
  - Sounding rote and mechanised
  - Adding comments which include new information and target the interests of the group
- Knowing when to be quiet – many people who deliver commentaries seem to think their job is to talk 'all the time' and this is definitely not the requirement.



It is important to keep quiet to allow participants to:

- Have a break from being talked to
- Experience the activity or tour in relative peace and quiet
- Enjoy the experience on their own
- Adjusting the commentary as required – to accommodate:
  - Identified interest of the group
  - Emerging events.

## Use prepared aids and materials and equipment to support presentation

A standard element of many interpretive activities is the need to use prepared aids and materials as well as suitable equipment to support presentation.

The following are important considerations regarding aids and materials to be used in an interpretive activity:

- All aids and materials to be used for an interpretive activity need to have been prepared and packed as part of the planning and preparation process for a tour. It is 'too late' to do this on-tour because there is just too much else to do
- Aids and materials must be appropriate to the individual nature of the activity – and:
  - Allow the identified objectives to be attained
  - Reflect requested information
  - Revised regularly to ensure they match changed conditions
- Items must be sufficient in number – so every tour group member receives 'their own' copy of hard copy materials
- Items must be 'user-friendly' – this can mean they need to be:
  - Presented in a language which can be understood
  - Clear and unambiguous
  - Easy to handle.



### ***Types of aids and materials***

Aids and materials can cover an extremely wide range of physical and human resources.

The following is representative of what is commonly used:

- Hard copy items which will vary depending on the type of activity – such as:
  - Safety tips
  - Information handouts
  - Rules of the game
  - Permanent ('take home') copy of the scripted commentary provided by the Tour Guide
  - Maps
  - Diagrams
  - Photographs
  - Sight cards
  - Activity sheets
  - Exercise sheets
  - Question sheets
  - Score cards



- Activity-related physical resources (not including safety or PPE) – which may include:
  - Sports gear
  - Props
  - Costumes
  - Equipment and items specific to the individual nature and need of particular activities – for example:
    - Pens
    - Note books
    - Binoculars
    - Nets
  - Special needs gear – to optimise engagement of participants with medical issues, disabilities or other individual needs
  - Natural resources – as appropriate
- Human resources – in the form of:
  - Sufficient observers – to monitor activities and intervene when safety is threatened
  - Performers and actors
  - Players, teams and troupes
  - Presenters and demonstrators
  - Guest speakers
  - Assistants
  - Involvement of special interest organisations and groups
- Equipment and technology often includes:
  - PA systems and microphones
  - Megaphones
  - Overhead projectors
  - Data projectors
  - Slides and transparencies
  - Sound and lighting technologies
  - Laser pointers
  - Personal electronic devices.





## **Activity 20 - Provide commentary for an eco-tourism activity**

You are asked to provide interpretive commentary for your activity.

As part of this 10 minute presentation to your class you are required to:

- Introducing the interpretive activity
- Provide a suitable welcome
- Explain the activity to be conducted
- Provide all information the customer may need to fully understand the activity
- Provide commentary about the activity or site in an interesting manner
- Provide demonstrations where required
- Explain safety issues (if required)
- Engage and interact with the group
- Provide any materials or aid to enhance the presentation.



### **Anticipate issues**

All Tour Guides need to consider 'issues arising' during the conduct of the tour when they schedule an interpretive activity.

Examples of issues arising can be:

- Previous interpretive activities running over time and leaving less time for the next activity
- Previous interpretive activities running under time thus leaving extra time for the next activity
- Need to cancel or in some way amend an interpretive activity because of safety, weather or other reasons
- Requests or demands from tour group members for certain things to be done, changed or omitted from the itinerary
- Unacceptable behaviour or attitudes demonstrated by certain tour group members
- Accidents or incidents which have occurred when the tour group participated in a previous interpretive activity
- Vehicle breakdown or road closures which have caused delays to the itinerary
- Sickness of tour group members or involvement of participants in an accident of some sort.



Reasons Tour Guides need to consider these issues are to give them time to plan possible action:

- To adjust timing of the activity to maintain the itinerary times
- To adjust activities to accommodate the requests or competency level of tour group members
- To notify other personnel regarding the issues arising and how they will impact the upcoming interpretive activity
- To integrate new experiences into an activity because that learning was unable to be delivered in a previous activity that was cancelled or cut short
- To make sure respect for host communities is maintained – for example, where a decision may be made to cancel an activity due to unacceptable behaviour of a tour group
- To optimise the safety of tour group members with reference to whatever issue is deemed to be potentially impacting them.



### ***Activity 21- Identify and resolve possible issues***

You are asked to outline possible issues that may arise by conducting your tour or activity.

For each possible issue, please identify possible remedies that can be undertaken to eliminate or resolve the issue

| ISSUE | POSSIBLE RESOLUTION TO ELIMINATE ISSUE |
|-------|----------------------------------------|
|       |                                        |
|       |                                        |
|       |                                        |
|       |                                        |
|       |                                        |
|       |                                        |

## 2.5 Revise developed eco-tourism activities on the basis of feedback

## 3.3 Incorporate new knowledge in existing activities

## 3.5 Correct information and activities that prove to be inaccurate or misleading

### Introduction

Once the trial interactive activity has taken place, it is now time to review and evaluate the success of the trial and to make recommendations for future success.

All interpretive activities need to be reviewed and evaluated as part of standard operating procedures.

The review process should guide and drive changes to tours, interpretive activities and general operations.

This section gives reasons the review and evaluation needs to occur, describes the concept of a scheduled system and lists activities inherent in establishing and implementing such a system.



### Purpose of conducting a review and evaluation

Interpretive activities need to be reviewed and evaluated to:

- Determine if the activities are effective – that is, if they are achieving their desired outcomes
- Assess whether or not the activities remain relevant – to the tour, to other stakeholders and tour objectives
- Identify satisfaction levels of tour group members – who have experienced and engaged with the activities
- Work out the extent to which the activities ‘as delivered’ in reality match:
  - Advertisements and claims made about the activities
  - Expectations tour group members have about the activities
- Calculate the cost of conducting the activities – to compare this against projections for cost
- Meet quality assurance obligations – as imposed under various QA schemes the Tour Operator might subscribe to
- Provide current and actual data to management – to help with decision-making regarding the operation of tours and inclusion of activities
- Confirm all management protocols remain valid and effective – in terms of (for example) controls, supervision, staffing, safety, ethical operations.



## Evaluate actual presentation of the interpretive activity against target performance criteria

A standard element of many evaluations is to consider the extent to which each interpretive activity achieved its projected performance objectives.

### **Performance criteria**

In relation to interpretive activities, 'performance criteria' refer to the range of indicators selected by Tour Operators to help them determine the extent to which individual interpretive activities which were conducted achieved the objectives set for them during the planning phase.

They are:

- Standards (criteria) against which performance is judged
- Sub-sets of individual objectives.

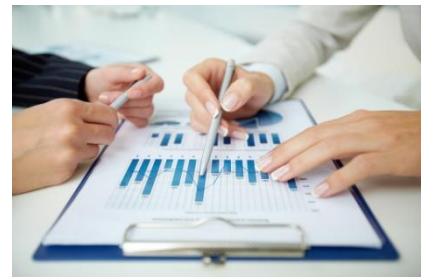
They can also be known as KPIs or 'evaluation criteria'.

There is no limit to what performance criteria can be used in an evaluation but they should have been clearly identified and described during the planning stage so stakeholders know in advance how activities will be evaluated.

The one performance criteria can be used to help evaluate multiple objectives and interpretive activities.

Performance criteria will always differ between interpretive activities and may relate to:

- Describing the physical, cost-related and geographic parameters within which interpretive activities are required to take place
- Expressing the required level of satisfaction tour group members will experience from the activity
- Describing and quantifying the impact of activities on the environment, sustainability, local communities or other identified factors – such as infrastructure, business activity within local businesses
- Matching presentation of interpretive activities against advertisements and claims made – about what the activities will deliver
- Alignment between obligations the Tour Operator is under – in relation to requirements imposed by:
  - Legislation
  - Codes
  - Agreements and compacts
- Involving local communities and nominated groups or individuals – in the planning and implementation of activities
- Protecting nominated aspects of host communities – in terms of:
  - Observing restricted areas
  - Honouring agreements to keep identified information secret
  - Ensuring safety and security of the population.





## ***Evaluating actual presentation***

The keys are:

- The stated performance criteria as stated in the plans are the standards which must be used – it is always possible to add extra performance criteria but at a minimum those developed during the planning phase need to be implemented
- Actual evidence, proof or data must be used in the evaluation – as opposed to relying on hunches or ‘beliefs’.
  - The information used for evaluation purposes may not always be objective data, but it should nonetheless be data as distinct from pure guesswork or a total lack of data
- Statistical analysis is at the heart of the process – this means:
  - Evidence needs to be quantified or presented in statistical form
  - Analysis will need to be presented in some arithmetic format – such as in the form of percentages or ratios
- The evaluation itself is a simple process of comparing the expected figure for each performance criteria as stated in the relevant plan with the findings of the actual data
- The process should result in the generation of findings – which may lead to:
  - Expressed in terms of outcomes
  - Written Recommendations or Suggestions
- The performance criteria used for the evaluation need to be reviewed and revised where necessary at every evaluation – to:
  - Ensure they remain relevant to changing conditions, activities, contexts, objectives and target markets
  - Fine-tune them so they can be better used to analyse and evaluate performance.





## **Activity 22 - Identify criteria to evaluate trail performance**

You are asked to identify key criteria in which you would evaluate and measure the success of your trail run against.

Identify methods you would use to measure actual performance against each of these performance criteria.

| PERFORMANCE CRITERIA | METHOD TO MEASURE ACTUAL PERFORMANCE AGAINST PERFORMANCE CRITERIA |
|----------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------|
|                      |                                                                   |
|                      |                                                                   |
|                      |                                                                   |
|                      |                                                                   |
|                      |                                                                   |
|                      |                                                                   |

### **Conducting review and evaluation**

Activities necessary will vary slightly depending on the activities and tours being evaluated but will commonly incorporate a standard set of tasks, such as

- Holding meetings – with stakeholders
- Reviewing customer feedback– as part of the standard and ongoing feedback process the Tour Operator should normally engage in at the conclusion of every tour
- Distributing feedback forms – to those from whom feedback is required
- Encouraging feedback – and asking people to comment



- Interviewing stakeholders face-to-face – individually or in groups using formal questionnaires
- Observing implementation of activities in order to record required data
- Entering data into the system for analysis
- Determining whether or not more data needs to be obtained or if current data requires clarification
- Assessing and analysing the information against the objectives set for the review process – and making recommendations or drawing conclusions from the process based on evidence gained
- Reporting on the process – to management and identified stakeholders.

## De-brief with colleagues

An extremely important part of the process when evaluating interpretive activities is the need to de-brief with colleagues who have been involved with planning and presenting those activities.

A de-briefing is a meeting with colleagues after a tour or activity has taken place.

It is undertaken to obtain feedback on:

- What happened
- What could be improved
- Problems occurring with the activity or tour.

### *Types of colleagues*

The colleagues who may be involved in the de-briefing might include:

- Tour Guides who present the tours or activities
- Drivers who assist with the tours or activities
- Internal sales staff – who sell tickets to tours or activities
- Agents and partners who assist in selling the tours or activities
- Presenters, performers and others used in the interpretive activities.



### *De-briefing activities with colleagues*

Activities commonly undertaken include, but not limited to:

- Conduct formal meetings with management – when employees believe an issue warrants such a meeting
- Soliciting verbal feedback – through:
  - Talking to colleagues when they return after a tour or activity
  - Raising de-briefing feedback as a standing item at staff meetings
- Obtaining written feedback from colleagues – by:
  - Making it mandatory for staff to complete and forward designated forms within given timeframes after a tour or activity has been conducted

- Analysing written reports – in order to:
  - Identify issues
  - Determine causal factors
  - Decide action to take in response, if necessary
  - Resolve issues, if required
- Evaluating staff perceptions – about nominated topics such as:
  - Levels of customer satisfaction
  - Input by third parties
  - Suitability of resourcing
  - Feelings regarding the need for change
- Considering complaints received, or overheard, from customers – with a view to:
  - Determining legitimacy of issues
- Taking appropriate action in response
- Learning lessons to improve delivery and prevent recurrence
- Reviewing comments from ‘relevant others’ – such as feedback from customers, input from third parties or contributions from stakeholders.



## Seek feedback from customers

In the same way Tour Operators seek input from their staff they also seek feedback from their customers.

Even during a 'trial' the feedback from customers is essential in seeing how the experience was perceived by the end user.



### **Methods to obtain customer feedback**

Customer feedback can be obtained by making personal observations of customers by tour staff in terms of:

- Noting the body language of people – and watching their reactions:
  - At various locations and activities
  - When they arrive at certain destinations to being activities or tours
  - When they engage with nominated interpretive activities
- Listening to what tour group members say:
  - As they take part in an activity
  - When they get back on board the tour vehicle after an activity
  - When they return after the tour has finished

- Soliciting written feedback provided by tour group members – in terms of:
  - Written Comments cards as they leave the tour
  - Online feedback received – which is available any time for people to use
  - Letters of complaints or compliments received
- Using other market research techniques – such as:
- Surveys or Response Sheets – such as Customer Satisfaction surveys conducted at the end of tours or activities
- Targeted questionnaires – about activities and tours
- Focus groups – undertaken with a cohort of participants whose characteristics mirror those of tour and activity users
- Analysing comments made by and input received from third party providers, co-chair operators or joint-venture partners – on the basis of:
  - Formal feedback made to them by customers
  - Feedback initiatives they have implemented
  - Overheard comments.

## Identifying revisions to interpretive tours or activities

Professionalism in delivery of an interpretive activity requires modification of ‘standard’ presentation to suit the emerging needs of future groups.

It is important revisions to be made to tours or activities are based on evidence as revealed by the evaluation.

In some cases there can be a need to discuss proposed revisions with host communities to obtain their approval prior to making implementing the revisions.

As discussed, there is an ongoing need to monitor the activity and adjust it to suit emerging requirements in order to:

- Optimise customer enjoyment and engagement
- Accommodate and respond to general issues arising for the group
- Keep the activity on schedule and the tour running according to the itinerary
- Cater for individual needs, wants and preferences as they are identified
- Demonstrate customer-focus and a genuine service ethic.

## Types of revisions

There are endless revisions that can take place including but not limited to:

- Altering plans – in terms of:
  - Operational plans – to enable achievement of new or revised operational imperatives, requirements, objectives and performance criteria
  - Contingency plans – generated to provide alternative activities and options
  - Emergency plans – where the new or revised activity has introduced an issue which needs to be addressed

- Acquiring extra or different resources – to enable the activities to:
  - Be conducted as intended
  - Cater for revised numbers participating in each activity
  - Provide items or equipment demanded by previous customers
  - Feature more upgraded or 'better' resources
- Acquiring extra information – to:
  - Meet requirements new or revised inclusions
  - Cater for new or re-defined audiences or groups
  - Address deficiencies identified by customer feedback
- Preparing revised or new activities – to:
  - Accommodate newly identified requests or demands
  - Respond to valid criticism of previous offerings
  - Match the needs, wants and preferences of new or emerging markets
- Generating revised or new commentaries – to:
  - Provide information appropriate to new or revised inclusions, routes, content, objectives, activities
  - Reflect changes to the itinerary, travel routes and times
  - Incorporate specifics of new or revised activities
- Incorporate new knowledge in existing activities may include:
  - Amending activities to suit new information, including static and interactive activities
  - Updating printed materials provided to customers, including handouts and static signage at displays
  - Changing the commentaries to include new information
- Changing the basic tenor of an activity – which may mean:
  - Switching from an active to a passive orientation
  - Allowing the tour group to determine their approach to the activity rather than insisting the plans for the activity are followed
- Altering the pacing of the presentation – by (for example)
  - Speeding up or slowing down commentary
  - Adding more information or omitting 'nice to know' information and presenting only the 'need to know' detail
- Changing the scope of the activity itself – by:
  - Adding new or different elements
  - Reducing objectives or dimensions of the activity



- Adjusting the duration of the activity – which may take the form of:
  - Making the activity longer or shorter
  - Breaking the overall activity up into smaller, discreet sections
  - Introducing rests periods into the activity
- Addressing the degree of engagement and participation of the tour group with the activity – which will commonly require either:
  - The tour group members to do more or less
  - The tour group members to do something different – such as something more active or less active, challenging or hands-on
  - The Tour Guide or tour staff members to do more or less
- Altering the level of communication and interaction with individuals and or groups – to:
  - Make people feel more included
  - Address signs of distress, fatigue or other negative signals
  - Enhance the connection between Tour Guide and the individual.
- Taking action in relation to the administration of the activity – which may require changes in relation to:
  - Monitoring of the group
  - Supervision of the activity
  - Provision of further advice
  - Feedback given
- Moving the location of the activity – to:
  - A better area given the nature of issues arising
  - A safer site
- Responding to changing environmental and other factors – including those related to:
  - Safety
  - Weather
  - Environment
- Abandoning planned activities and initiating a substitute alternative activity – where the original interpretive activity appears to be unacceptable and inappropriate
- Changing the promotional activities for the tour – in terms of:
  - Printed materials and signage or posters
  - Online content
  - Media campaigns





- Amending staffing for the tour – which may require:
  - More or less staff
  - More or less hours for existing staff
  - Different staff with different experience, expertise and skills sets
- Changing parameters relating to tour customers – which could mean:
  - Increasing or decreasing group size or numbers
  - Imposing or easing restrictions or limitations on participants – age, fitness, mobility, disability.

## 2.6 Promote prepared eco-tourism activities

### Introduction

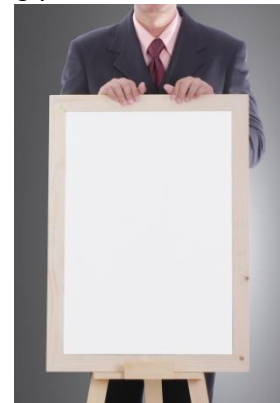
After all planning, preparation and trails for interpretive activities have been completed there can be a need to promote both the tour and the activities.

This section identifies possible considerations and requirements for this important element of marketing.

### Promotional considerations

Whenever there is a need to promote a tour or activity the following are important points to consider:

- Adhere to the budget for advertising – there will always be a limit about how much can be spent
- Target intended customers – as identified by internal target marketing plans and demographic characteristics
- Use language appropriate to each target market – so they can understand and relate to the messages
- Leverage joint-venture promotions – so cost and benefits are shared
- Time the promotion to coincide with availability of the tour or activity – so interest is created ‘sufficiently’ in advance
- Use a variety of advertising mediums and channels – to obtain maximum reach and coverage
- Develop and use a promotion plan – to guide the when, where, why and how of advertising
- Update and revise advertising – as tours and activities change.



### Types of promotional activities

There is no comprehensive list of things to do to promote tours and activities.

Typically a blend of ‘traditional’ tried and tested options mixed with ‘innovative’ approaches is recommended.

The following is indicative of what may be required:

- Writing advertisements – these need to be targeted to suit:
  - Individual audiences
  - The unique needs of the particular medium being used
- Designing promotional material – to be:
  - Used online
  - Distributed to agents and partners
  - Included in all forms of advertising and publicity



- Selecting the media to be used – in terms of:
  - Standard media outlets – press, radio, television
  - Types of media or hardware
  - Hard copy options – such as brochures, leaflets, flyers
  - Electronic options – such as online promotional videos and DVDs for use within the Tour Operation and by agents
- Supplying media releases to the media – to encourage media interest in tours and activities and as a way of obtaining ‘free’ advertising
- Conducting media events – to launch activities or tours and to generate media interest and coverage
- Inviting agents to participate – by providing travel to the tours, accommodation and meals while on-site as well as free tours so gain first-hand experience which can be used to help sell the tours or activities
- Providing free tours, travel and accommodation to the media – so they can experience the tour or activity and hopefully write positive media coverage
- Creating merchandise to support the tour or attraction – which may be:
  - Given away as promotional items
  - Sold as advertising and brand awareness
- Allocating resources to support the promotion – in terms of:
  - Staff to handle enquiries, sales, media liaison
  - Staff to respond to online queries and generate a social media presence
  - Funds to pay for brochures and flyers, advertising materials, bought advertising and expenses related to all aspects of promotion
  - Commissions payable to businesses and agencies who sell tours and activities on behalf of the host organisations
- Distributing promotional materials to targeted outlets – such as:
  - Accommodation venues – for use in guest rooms and concierge
  - Other tourist attractions and destinations
  - Visitor Information Centres
- Participating in a variety of shows – such as:
  - Trade shows
  - Tourism expos
  - Local or regional promotional initiatives
- Using a range of personalities to sell the message – such as:
  - Celebrities
  - Sports stars
  - Bands.





## Work Projects

It is a requirement of this Unit you complete Work Projects as advised by your Trainer. You must submit documentation, suitable evidence or other relevant proof of completion of the project to your Trainer by the agreed date.

2.1 Please complete the following activities relating to this Performance Criteria:

- Activities 11,12

2.2 Please complete the following activities relating to this Performance Criteria:

- Activities 13,14,15

2.3 Please complete the following activities relating to this Performance Criteria:

- Activity 16

2.4 Please complete the following activities relating to this Performance Criteria:

- Activities 17,18,19,20,21

2.5 Please complete the following activities relating to this Performance Criteria:

- Activity 22

2.6 Please complete the following activities relating to this Performance Criteria:

- Activity 23
-

## Summary

### Prepare an eco-tourism activity

#### **Develop and determine concepts, themes and focal points for potential eco-tourism activities / Create new activities**

- Key points of determining and creating activities
- Objectives of interpretive activities
- Setting objectives for each eco-tourism activity
- Developing interpretive activities
- Considerations when selecting interpretive activities
- Types of interpretive activities
- Planning interpretive activities
- Using specialist personnel
- Involve local community participation.

#### **Acquire physical resources to support identified eco-tourism concepts, themes and focal points**

- Importance of identifying required resources
- Types of resources required to deliver interpretive activities
- Development or acquisition resources
- Obtaining necessary permits.

#### **Generate scripted commentaries to support identified eco-tourism concepts, themes and focal points**

- Benefits of commentary scripts
- Considerations when preparing commentary scripts
- Principles for writing commentary scripts.

#### **Trial developed eco-tourism activities for identified concepts, themes and focal points**

- Trial eco-tourism activities
- Undertake planning of eco-tourism activities
- Prepare interpretive activity requirements
- Respect for local communities
- Ensure safety issues are addressed
- Conduct briefings with staff
- Introducing the interpretive activity
- Key points of interpretive activity to explain
- Using recorded introductions
- Explaining interpretive activities
- Communication techniques
- Demonstrate activity pre-requisites
- Confirm customer understanding of upcoming activity
- Provide interpretive commentary

- Use prepared aids and materials and equipment to support presentation
- Anticipate issues.

**Revise developed eco-tourism activities on the basis of feedback /**

**Incorporate new knowledge in existing activities /**

**Correct information and activities that prove to be inaccurate or misleading**

- Purpose of conducting a review and evaluation
- Evaluate actual presentation of the interpretive activity against target performance criteria
- Conducting review and evaluation
- De-brief with colleagues
- Seek feedback from customers
- Identifying revisions to interpretive tours or activities
- Types of revisions.

**Promote prepared eco-tourism activities**

- Promotional considerations
- Types of promotional activities.





## Element 3: Update knowledge and eco-tourism activities

### 3.1 Take action to receive information from relevant bodies

#### Introduction

It is important to be up-to-date with the ever changing industry, especially in relation to eco-tourism trends and developments.

This might mean that you have to find out information about a particular eco-tourism topic, location, attraction, trend or customer preference.

Whatever the case may be, always remember that having information about the industry and apply it to your daily practices can not only boost your sales but identify opportunities for you to expand your organisation to new customer segments, new tours and new attractions.

In Section 1.2 of this manual, a range of sources of information was explained.

Whilst that section focused on gathering specific information in relation to specific tours and events you may run, they are also useful in ensuring your industry knowledge is maintained and updated.

To avoid duplication, any sources of information identified in Section 1.2 will not be repeated in this section.



#### Updating eco-tourism knowledge

To keep learning, you must source the most recent and relevant information about what is happening in the eco-tourism industry in general, your sector of interest and your workplace especially.

#### ***Areas to monitor***

You should seek to identify a wide range of issues such as:

- New eco-tourism developments
- New topics for discussion
- New laws and regulations relating to eco-tourism in your region
- New eco-tourism related products, services, tours and activities
- Trends and selling prices of the products and services being offered by both your business and elsewhere throughout the industry

- Activities the opposition is undertaking to attract customers or to meet competition in the market place
- Changing and emerging trends
- New techniques and workplace practices
- New equipment and technology
- Initiatives relating to advertising, marketing and promotion
- Market research information – which identifies the needs, wants and preferences of customers.



## Monitor current issues of concern

The eco-tourism industry is constantly presented with new and various issues. All managers should be actively monitoring current issues of concern to the industry and their particular business,

### *Causes of issues of concern*

By definition, issues of concern will change over time. The marketplace and the industry 'ever-changing' and all the factors at play are constantly interacting with each other and creating new problems and new opportunities.

For example, the business environment we are experiencing and operating in today is constantly changing and these differences are caused by individual factors or a combination of factors such as:

- The state of the economy
- Eco-tourism practices
- Environmental considerations and concerns
- Terrorism
- Customer confidence
- Weather
- Technological and legislative changes that impact on the industry.





## **Activity 24 - Identify trends and issues affecting eco-tourism industry**

You are required to identify a range of trends and issues that are currently affecting the eco-tourism industry, as related specifically to your region.

| TYPE OF TREND or ISSUE | KEY POINTS OF TREND or ISSUE | METHOD TO GATHER INFORMATION |
|------------------------|------------------------------|------------------------------|
|                        |                              |                              |
|                        |                              |                              |
|                        |                              |                              |
|                        |                              |                              |
|                        |                              |                              |
|                        |                              |                              |

### **Methods to update industry knowledge**

As a summary of Section 1.2 some examples of sources that can be used as opportunities to update knowledge of the eco-tourism industry:

- Formal and informal research
- Media
- Reference books
- Industry associations and organisations
- Industry journals
- Personal experience
- Educationals
- Functions
- On-the-job
- Taking the time to visit the opposition.



Following are other methods that can be used to update your industry knowledge:

## Establishing industry networks

### *Developing your own industry network*

As a member of the eco-tourism industry, it is vital to build your industry network. This involves reaching out to all people in all aspects of the industry and discussing industry happening, trends and current information.

The more people you meet and the more information you accumulate provides you with a sound understanding of the industry and will help your career progression.

### *Networking with industry colleagues*

It is very worthwhile to network with industry colleagues when you get the opportunity to attend product launches, seminars, educational and the like.

You are not only constantly learning but you are also mixing with other tourism professionals, many of them having knowledge, experience and skills that you do not have.



## **Activity 25 - Creating an industry network**

You are to identify five (5) possible contacts whom you would like to invite to an industry network you would create.

This network can be used for whatever purpose you decide, including seeking assistance and advice or to share ideas.



| Desired contact | Contact details | Purpose of inclusion in an industry network |
|-----------------|-----------------|---------------------------------------------|
|                 |                 |                                             |
|                 |                 |                                             |
|                 |                 |                                             |
|                 |                 |                                             |
|                 |                 |                                             |

## Attend conferences and seminars

You should attend these whenever possible and make an effort to attend a major one at least every two years. Let your employer know you are interested in attending and keep an eye in the media and trade publications about events that are coming up.

Conferences and seminars are extremely useful because they are:

- A great source of industry contacts. It is beneficial to begin 'networking' as soon as possible
- Good sources of new ideas, new products and new industry thinking
- A good opportunity to share and test ideas.

If you can't attend them, then make sure you read about them in the trade magazines or make contact with someone who has attended.



## Contact information services

Most information services are fee-for-service providers. This means it costs money to use their services.

These services capture and analyse information from various industry areas. For example, they may focus on issues such as industry trends, sources of inbound tourists, interpretation of other specific market data. The range of topics is virtually limitless.

In addition, most government agencies provide information to employers and these too can be regarded as information services. Most of these services are free and available as:

- E-newsletters
- Fact Sheets
- Updates
- Guides
- Information Sheets
- Over-the-phone advice from inspectors, field officers or other appropriate personnel within the agency.



In many cases, authorised officers will often visit your premises to assist you in addressing nominated issues.

## Registering for information

When sourcing information, whilst direct contact with external providers, as mentioned above is an invaluable way to get information regarding specific products and services, quite often you may need to gather more generic information relating to the industry as a whole, including any new laws, regulations, businesses or trends.

This information will commonly be obtained through various publications, produced by leading government or industry leaders and authorities.

In order to access this information you will need to register to receive it.

Registering for industry information may include:

- Registering on-line
- Paying a fee
- Establishing required password and username, if required
- Lodging host enterprise details with product information source
- Establishing the bona fides of the host enterprise
- Joining an association or body in order to enable access.







## Activity 26 – Identify publications to register



What are examples of publications, either in hard copy or online, that you would register to access valuable information that would suit an organisation providing eco-tourism tours and activities.

| Name of publication | Format of publication | Reasons for registering to publication | Key features | Cost |
|---------------------|-----------------------|----------------------------------------|--------------|------|
|                     |                       |                                        |              |      |
|                     |                       |                                        |              |      |
|                     |                       |                                        |              |      |
|                     |                       |                                        |              |      |
|                     |                       |                                        |              |      |
|                     |                       |                                        |              |      |

## 3.2 File and share new information

### Introduction

As identified in the previous section it is critical for your industry knowledge to remain up-to-date and accurate as this will be one of your most powerful selling tools.

When you have managed to gather updated information, knowledge or skills you must be prepared to share that information and incorporate it into your day-to-day work activities.



In addition, any general communication or changes that have been made to specific tours or activities, either as part of general communicating or that resulting from industry changes or resulting from evaluation of trial activities, as identified in Section 2.5, must be communicated to all stakeholders in a timely manner.

In Section 1.5 the process of classifying and storing information has been discussed.

In this section we will focus on sharing information relating to:

- General industry knowledge
- Specific tours and activities.

### Sharing general industry knowledge

The basic ways to share information with fellow colleagues are to:

- Tell your colleagues about what you have learned – on a one-on-one basis, or at staff briefings or meetings
- E-mail co-workers with the information you have discovered
- Prepare a short handout – put this on the notice board or photocopy and distribute it.

Ways to share new knowledge with customers, depending on the type of information involved can include:

- Verbally providing advice that includes the new information
- Preparing posters to share the information
- Producing handouts.

Incorporating knowledge into everyday practice can include:

- Working in accordance with new or revised requirements
- Using new knowledge to modify personal work practices
- Updating printed materials
- Supplying information to customers that incorporate the new knowledge.



## Sharing specific tours and activities information

As mentioned, whether in the course of normal operations or due to changes made to tours and activities, information must be communicated with a wide range of vested stakeholders.

### *Types of stakeholders*

The various types of stakeholders who may have a vested interest in tours and activities include, but not limited to:

- Host communities – including:
  - Acknowledged community leaders
  - Designated elders
  - Nominated spokespeople or representatives
  - Vehicles operated by third party carriers in these communities
- Tour operator employees who are also part of the tour group – such as:
  - Tour managers
  - Drivers of coaches and other vehicles owner and operated by the Tour Operator
  - Employees responsible for loading vehicles and conducting pre-departure checks
  - Security or safety staff
  - Aides and assistants
  - Cooks
- Third party providers, joint venture partner and agencies – in terms of:
  - Drivers they use
  - People provided to ‘meet and greet’ tour group members and to provide other services at and within activities
  - Caterers
  - Animal handlers
- Local and independent guides – who may be have a role to play in:
  - Leading part of the tour
  - Conducting an activity
- Designated contacts at destinations, suppliers and venues – including:
  - Hotels and restaurants
  - Attractions and sites
  - Retail shops



- Land owners and land managers – for areas which:
  - May be protected by legislation or regulation
  - May be subject to special listing and access requirements
  - Require payment of user fees on arrival
- Representatives of statutory authorities – who may need to be advised of:
  - Plans and intentions – for tours and activities
  - Projected usage of areas or sites
  - Numbers of visitors
  - Other detail as applicable to the individual authority.



## Nature of communication with stakeholders

Liaising with stakeholders centres round a number of activities which require 'engagement' with people.

These activities are sometimes regular and predictable and at other times subject to the individual whims and vagaries of different customers and different activity types.

Generally these activities include:

- Responding to requests from colleagues for assistance – these can come from destinations, carriers and suppliers in cases where:
  - They notify they are unable to provide normal services as previously arranged
  - They advise scheduled activities cannot be delivered at planned times
  - The arranged service cannot be supplied as arranged
- Asking them for assistance – as dictated by a wide number of potential reasons such as:
  - Seeking to accommodate special needs customers who have been identified
  - Requesting changes to normal arrangements – to accommodate issues arising as the activity proceeds
  - Responding to specific requests made by tour group members while participating in the activity
- Liaising with individuals and properties – in order to:
  - Make operational decisions
  - Alter planned arrangements
  - Advise of changes and issues impacting the activity, the tour and the itinerary
  - Keep people apprised of tour progress and where the tour 'currently' is and its expected arrival at other locations and activities



- Providing support for the work of others – such as:
  - Supplying information and facts as required by others in relation to the tour and operational details of individual activities
  - Passing on feedback received from tour group members about the activity and the tour
  - Assisting others complete their work as it relates to the activity
  - Integrating new requested work-related activities into standard interpretive activity protocols
- Anticipating requests from colleagues – and:
  - Responding positively
  - Responding proactively
  - Striving to achieve a mutually beneficial outcome
- Communicating with venues, sites, destinations and providers – and:
  - Confirming forward bookings
  - Advising sites and operators of expected arrival time, group numbers, special requests and timing constraints that may apply
  - Making arrangements
  - Negotiating changes to standard arrangements
- Making payment for services and products rendered according to previously agreed arrangements, or as required – to:
  - Suppliers
  - Communities
  - Carriers.



## Conclusion

As can be seen in this manual, there are many considerations and tasks that must be thought through when planning, implementing, conducting, communicating, monitoring, evaluating and revising eco-tourism interpretive tours and activities.

Hopefully this manual provides a sound platform in which to successfully plan and conduct tours and activities.



## Work Projects

It is a requirement of this Unit you complete Work Projects as advised by your Trainer. You must submit documentation, suitable evidence or other relevant proof of completion of the project to your Trainer by the agreed date.

3.1 Please complete the following activities relating to this Performance Criteria:

- Activities 24,25,26

3.2 Please complete the following activities relating to this Performance Criteria:

- Activity 27

3.3 Please complete the following activities relating to this Performance Criteria:

- Activity 22

3.4 Please complete the following activities relating to this Performance Criteria:

- Activities 11,12

3.5 Please complete the following activities relating to this Performance Criteria:

- Activities 3,4,5,7,22
-



## Summary

### Update knowledge and eco-tourism activities

#### Take action to receive information from relevant bodies

- Updating eco-tourism knowledge
- Monitor current issues of concern
- Methods to update industry knowledge
- Establishing industry networks
- Attend conferences and seminars
- Contact information services
- Registering for information.

#### File and share new information

- Sharing general industry knowledge
- Sharing specific tours and activities information
- Nature of communication with stakeholders.

# Presentation of written work

## 1. Introduction

It is important for students to present carefully prepared written work. Written presentation in industry must be professional in appearance and accurate in content. If students develop good writing skills whilst studying, they are able to easily transfer those skills to the workplace.

## 2. Style



Students should write in a style that is simple and concise. Short sentences and paragraphs are easier to read and understand. It helps to write a plan and at least one draft of the written work so that the final product will be well organised. The points presented will then follow a logical sequence and be relevant. Students should frequently refer to the question asked, to keep 'on track'. Teachers recognise and are critical of work that does not answer the question, or is 'padded' with irrelevant material. In summary, remember to:

- Plan ahead
- Be clear and concise
- Answer the question
- Proofread the final draft.

## 3. Presenting Written Work

### *Types of written work*

Students may be asked to write:

- Short and long reports
- Essays
- Records of interviews
- Questionnaires
- Business letters
- Resumes.



### *Format*

All written work should be presented on A4 paper, single-sided with a left-hand margin. If work is word-processed, one-and-a-half or double spacing should be used. Handwritten work must be legible and should also be well spaced to allow for ease of reading. New paragraphs should not be indented but should be separated by a space. Pages must be numbered. If headings are also to be numbered, students should use a logical and sequential system of numbering.

**Cover Sheet**

All written work should be submitted with a cover sheet stapled to the front that contains:

- The student's name and student number
- The name of the class or unit
- The due date of the work
- The title of the work
- The teacher's name
- A signed declaration that the work does not involve plagiarism.

**Keeping a Copy**

Students must keep a copy of the written work in case it is lost. This rarely happens but it can be disastrous if a copy has not been kept.

**Inclusive language**

This means language that includes every section of the population. For instance, if a student were to write 'A nurse is responsible for the patients in her care at all times' it would be implying that all nurses are female and would be excluding male nurses.

Examples of appropriate language are shown on the right:

|                    |                                |
|--------------------|--------------------------------|
| Mankind            | <i>Humankind</i>               |
| Barman or maid     | <i>Bar attendant</i>           |
| Host or hostess    | <i>Host</i>                    |
| Waiter or waitress | <i>Waiter or waiting staff</i> |

# Recommended reading

Bramley, Zoe; 2014 (Kindle Edition); *Tour Guiding Skills: Lead Your Own Guided Walking Tours*; Amazon Digital Services

Chambers, Erve; 2009 (2nd edition); *Native Tours: The Anthropology of Travel and Tourism*; Waveland Pr Inc

Cook, Roy A & Hsu, Cathy H. C & Marqua, Joseph J; 2014 (5th edition); *Tourism: the business of hospitality and travel*; Boston Pearson.

Crabtree, Alice & South West Institute of TAFE; 2000 (1st edition); *Plan and develop interpretive activities*; South West Institute of TAFE

Coutts, Alex; 2013 (Kindle Edition); *Guide Culture Nature And Adventure Tours*; Alex Educational

Field, Gil & Western Australia. Department of Conservation and Land Management; 2000 (1st edition); *Developing ecotours and other interpretive activity programs: a guidebook for planning, designing, promoting and conducting ecotourism activity programs*; Dept. of Conservation, Como

Green, Ronda; 2013 (Kindle Edition); *Wildlife Tourism: A Handbook for Guides, Tour Operators, Job-seekers and Business Start-ups*; Ronda J. Green

Guyette, Susan; 2013 (1st edition); *Sustainable Cultural Tourism: Small-Scale Solutions*; BearPath Press

Honey, Martha; 2008 (2nd edition); *Ecotourism and Sustainable Development*; Island Press

Lanier, Pamela; 2013 (1st edition); *Sustainable Tourism: A Small Business Handbook for Success*; CreateSpace Independent Publishing Platform

McKercher, Bob; 2002 (1st edition); *Cultural Tourism: The Partnership Between Tourism and Cultural Heritage Management*; Routledge

Pastorelli, John; 2003 (1st edition); *Enriching the experience: an interpretive approach to tour guiding*; Pearson Education Australia

Patterson, Carol; 2007 (3rd edition); *The Business of Ecotourism*; Trafford Publishing

Weiler, Betty; 2014 (1st edition); *Tour Guiding Research: Insights, Issues and Implications*; Channel View Publications

Wurzburger, Rebecca; 2009 (1st edition); *Creative Tourism, A Global Conversation*; Sunstone Press



# Trainee evaluation sheet

## Develop interpretive content for eco-tourism activities

The following statements are about the competency you have just completed.

| Please tick the appropriate box                                 | Agree                    | Don't Know               | Do Not Agree             | Does Not Apply           |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------|--------------------------|--------------------------|--------------------------|
| There was too much in this competency to cover without rushing. | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| Most of the competency seemed relevant to me.                   | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| The competency was at the right level for me.                   | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| I got enough help from my trainer.                              | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| The amount of activities was sufficient.                        | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| The competency allowed me to use my own initiative.             | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| My training was well-organised.                                 | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| My trainer had time to answer my questions.                     | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| I understood how I was going to be assessed.                    | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| I was given enough time to practice.                            | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| My trainer feedback was useful.                                 | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| Enough equipment was available and it worked well.              | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| The activities were too hard for me.                            | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |

The best things about this unit were:

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The worst things about this unit were:

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The things you should change in this unit are:

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# Trainee self-assessment checklist

As an indicator to your Trainer or Assessor of your readiness for assessment in this unit please complete the following and hand to your Trainer or Assessor.

## Develop interpretive content for eco-tourism activities

|                                                   |                                                                                                    | Yes                      | No*                      |
|---------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------|--------------------------|
| <b>Element 1: Research information</b>            |                                                                                                    |                          |                          |
| 1.1                                               | Describe the interpretive approach to guiding and activities                                       | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| 1.2                                               | Identify sources of information for eco-tourism knowledge                                          | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| 1.3                                               | Determine customer interests and potential themes for possible interpretive activities             | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| 1.4                                               | Use research techniques to obtain information                                                      | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| 1.5                                               | Classify and store information                                                                     | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| 1.6                                               | Verify information that has been gathered                                                          | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| 1.7                                               | Learn the required information to support identified eco-tourism concepts, themes and focal points | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| <b>Element 2: Prepare an eco-tourism activity</b> |                                                                                                    |                          |                          |
| 2.1                                               | Develop and determine concepts, themes and focal points for potential eco-tourism activities       | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| 2.2                                               | Acquire physical resources to support identified eco-tourism concepts, themes and focal points     | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| 2.3                                               | Generate scripted commentaries to support identified eco-tourism concepts, themes and focal points | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| 2.4                                               | Trial developed eco-tourism activities for identified concepts, themes and focal points            | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| 2.5                                               | Revise developed eco-tourism activities on the basis of feedback                                   | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| 2.6                                               | Promote prepared eco-tourism activities                                                            | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |

|                                                               |                                                                              | Yes                      | No*                      |
|---------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------|--------------------------|
| <b>Element 3: Update knowledge and eco-tourism activities</b> |                                                                              |                          |                          |
| 3.1                                                           | Take action to receive information from relevant bodies                      | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| 3.2                                                           | File and share new information                                               | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| 3.3                                                           | Incorporate new knowledge in existing activities                             | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| 3.4                                                           | Create new activities                                                        | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| 3.5                                                           | Correct information and activities that prove to be inaccurate or misleading | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |

**Statement by Trainee:**

I believe I am ready to be assessed on the following as indicated above:

**Signed:** \_\_\_\_\_

**Date:** \_\_\_\_\_

**Note:**

For all boxes where a **No\*** is ticked, please provide details of the extra steps or work you need to do to become ready for assessment.



